A Project for a Sixth Republic

Towards a Federal Republic Founded on Solidarity

White Paper — Version V060 (December 2025)

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Document Control and Version History

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V058	achille@naffati.com	2025-11-05	Addition of Part IV (Delegated Public Policies) and Annexes 7 and 8.
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PART I — The Philosophical and Territorial Foundation: The Project’s Rationale and Map

This part brings together the foundations of the project: the diagnosis that motivates it, the philosophy that carries it, and its most concrete and visible expression — the new map of the Regions. It is the “why” and the “where.”

Preamble

The purpose of this document is to set out the founding principles of a new organization of the French Republic. Starting from the observation that the unitary, centralized state model

— having accomplished its historic mission of unification — is today reaching its economic and democratic limits, we sketch the contours of a "federalism *à la française*." This model seeks to reconcile the two deep aspirations of our social body: a yearning for liberty, rootedness, and local responsibility (the "Girondin" spirit), and a passion for equal rights and national solidarity (the "Jacobin" spirit).[1]

Our project makes the bold choice of grounding the new territorial map in the historical and cultural coherence of the Regions, rather than in a "critical mass" logic that produces vast but artificial administrative units. We embrace the paradox this entails: how can human-scale regions compete with Europe's large economic blocs?

The answer lies at the heart of our vision: the success of this model will rest not on the power of mass, but on the superiority of agility. Our Regions will have to offset their deficit in size with a surplus of speed, innovation, and adaptability. This agility will be decisional, thanks to strong and legitimate executives; it will be regulatory, through the capacity to craft tailor-made law for local centres of excellence; and it will, finally, be the agility of ecosystems, through the closeness of economic, academic, and political actors. We are not proposing a "federalism of power," but a "federalism of agility" — the only kind capable of meeting the challenges of a global economy in which responsiveness has become the chief competitive advantage.

It must be stressed that this document is a pure exercise in institutional foresight and reflection. It is tied to no party, political movement, or partisan agenda. The pronoun "we" used throughout this text designates a fictional, independent think tank whose sole aim is to explore, in complete freedom, new paths for the future organization of our Republic.

Chapter I: The Founding Concepts of Our Republican Pact

A refoundation of the Republic cannot be built on virgin ground. On the contrary, it must anchor itself firmly in the founding concepts that have forged France. If we choose to redefine them here, it is not as an academic exercise, but because we believe they have been weakened by centralization and by the distancing of power. The project of a Federal Sixth Republic does not aim to replace them, but to give them back life and meaning by entrusting them directly to the care of citizens. By making power more local and more participatory, we do not divide the Nation; we multiply the number of its guardians.

1. The State: From Distant Framework to Guarantor Close to Citizens

- **The concept:** The State is the permanent legal framework, defined by a territory, a population, and a sovereign authority. It is the guarantor of continuity and stability.

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[1] During the French Revolution, the Girondins favoured a decentralized republic granting autonomy to the provinces, while the Jacobins championed a strong, centralized state governed from Paris. The two terms have since come to denote the enduring tension in French political culture between local autonomy and central unity.

- **Its importance today:** In an unstable world, the State is more than ever a source of protection. It is the bulwark that ensures security, the permanence of the law, and the very existence of the political community. Yet the Jacobin State, through its concentration, has for many become a distant, bureaucratic entity — at times perceived as an adversary rather than a protector.

- **Why we strengthen it:** Our project does not aim for "less State," but for "better State." By transferring the bulk of public action to the regional level, we do not dismantle the State; we make it more tangible, more accessible, and more accountable. The Federal State, refocused on its essential missions of sovereignty and solidarity, becomes once again a strategic protector, while the Regional State becomes the everyday face of administrative effectiveness.

2. The Nation: From Imposed Unity to a Shared "Collective Will to Live Together"

- **The concept:** The Nation is the human community founded on a "collective will to live together" (Ernest Renan's subjective conception), a shared heritage and a common project.

- **Its importance today:** The Nation is the emotional cement that binds us to one another beyond our differences. But centralism has too often confused "unity" with "uniformity." By denying or folklorizing regional identities, it has at times weakened this "collective will to live together," creating the sense that belonging to the Nation required the erasure of local belongings.

- **Why we strengthen it:** The federalism we propose is the finest proof of confidence in the solidity of the French Nation. It rests on the wager that the Nation is strong enough not to fear its own diversity. By recognizing the legitimacy of regional identities and giving them political expression, we do not fracture the Nation: we strengthen the "collective will to live together" by founding it no longer on an imposed unity, but on voluntary adherence and an organized solidarity among territories proud of who they are and of what they bring to the national whole.

3. The Republic: From Proclaimed Values to Lived Values

- **The concept:** The Republic is the form of government which, in France, goes beyond the mere institutional framework to embody a political ideal founded on values (Indivisibility, Secularism, Democracy, and a Social character).

- **Its importance today:** These values are our most precious possession. Yet, when they are debated only in Paris, they can appear to many as abstract principles, disconnected from daily life. Democracy seems distant; solidarity is reduced to anonymous figures.

- **Why we strengthen it:** Our project aims to make each Region a living laboratory of the Republic. **Democracy** will be reinforced by the Regional Initiative Referendums, which will give citizens direct power over the law. The **Social** character will become concrete, because solidarity policies will be decided and managed as close as possible to needs on the ground. **Secularism** will be defended all the more forcefully because it will be the responsibility of each elected regional executive.

And **Indivisibility** will be guaranteed by the Federal Pact itself, which organizes solidarity among territories. By making these values live day to day, we make them stronger and better defended.

4. The Rule of Law: From Vertical Control to Citizen Control

- **The concept:** A State governed by the rule of law is one that submits itself to the law, guaranteeing fundamental freedoms through the hierarchy of norms and judicial review.

- **Its importance today:** It is the bulwark against the arbitrary exercise of power. Yet, in the current system, the review of the legality of local authorities' acts still lies largely in the hands of an agent of the central State: the Prefect.

- **Why we strengthen it:** Our project takes the rule of law to a higher stage. By abolishing the Prefect's political oversight and replacing it with **exclusively judicial review**, open to all citizens, we deepen democracy. Compliance with the law will no longer be the business of a single senior official, but of every citizen, who may bring a matter before a judge if they believe a public act — regional or municipal — is unlawful. The rule of law thus becomes everyone's concern.

Chapter II: A New Territorial Map Founded on History and Culture

The 2015 administrative redrawing, dictated by a technocratic "critical mass" logic, created often artificial units. Our project proposes a return to a more coherent map, founded on cultural and historical identities.

The choice of the Regions' boundaries is not a technical question, but the very first condition for the success of our federal project. A Region whose citizens do not feel they have a stake in it is an empty shell, incapable of carrying a political and economic project. This is why we propose a radical break with the administrative logic that has prevailed until now.

Section 1: The Diagnosis — The Failure of a Technocratic Map

The 2015 territorial reform was conceived on a single premise: "critical mass." By merging the former regions, the goal was to create entities of "European size," presumed to be more powerful and more rational. This vision, drawn up from Paris, ignored human, historical, and cultural realities, producing units that were often artificial and sometimes dysfunctional.

- **The example of the Grand Est: the forced union**

- **The current problem:** This region merges three deep and distinct identities: Alsace, with its Germanic history and local law; Lorraine, a former duchy with a strong industrial past; and Champagne, oriented toward the Paris Basin. The result is an absence of any common project and a strong sense of dispossession, particularly in Alsace. The creation in 2021 of the "European Collectivity of Alsace" is an admission of this failure: an administrative patch meant to soothe an identity crisis, without restoring genuine regional power.

- **Our project's solution:** By restoring Alsace, Lorraine, and Champagne as Regions in their own right, we give each territory back the capacity to define its own strategy, based on its assets (a cross-border vocation for Alsace, industrial reconversion for Lorraine, agro-industry for Champagne).
- **The example of Nouvelle-Aquitaine: the soulless Leviathan**
- **The current problem:** Larger than Austria, this region aggregates territories that share little. What real synergy exists between the aeronautics hub of Bordeaux, the porcelain industries of Limoges, and the tourism of the Basque Country? For the least populated territories, such as the Limousin, the merger translated into a feeling of being absorbed by the Bordeaux metropolis and a loss of all decision-making centres.
- **Our project's solution:** Our map distinguishes a coherent greater Aquitaine (Guyenne-Gascogne) centred on Bordeaux, a Limousin that recovers its capacity to address its own challenges (demographics, public services), and recognizes the specific character of the Basque Country.
- **The example of Auvergne-Rhône-Alpes: economic imbalance**
- **The current problem:** Here the marriage seems economically relevant, but it created an imbalanced whole between the hyper-dynamic Lyon metropolis and territories such as the Auvergne or the Southern Alps. Regional strategy is inevitably driven by the metropolis's interests, leaving rural and mountain areas with the feeling of being the "adjustment variable."
- **Our project's solution:** By separating the Auvergne, the Pays de Savoie, and the Dauphiné-Lyonnais, we allow each territory to play its own score. The Auvergne can pursue a policy focused on sustainable mobility and quality livestock farming; Savoie can concentrate on the mountain economy and mechatronics, without being diluted into an overly vast whole.

Section 2: The Principle — Coherence as a Lever of Performance

Our project does not propose a step backward out of nostalgia. It asserts that **historical and cultural coherence is the most relevant framework for public action in the 21st century**.

A human-scale Region, where citizens share a sense of belonging, is more effective because it benefits from:

- **A shared political project:** It is easier to define and gain acceptance for common priorities (such as the ecological transition of a mountain range or the reconversion of an industrial basin) when actors share a common history and destiny.

- **A “proximity intelligence”:** Mutual familiarity among elected officials, business leaders, university heads, and community-sector actors speeds up decision-making and fosters innovation.
- **Greater democratic legitimacy:** Citizens more readily take ownership of an institution that matches their lived “homeland,” which strengthens participation and democratic oversight.

It is on this basis that the “federalism of agility” we call for can be built.

Section 3: The Proposal — A France of Real “Pays”

The map we propose is therefore not an end in itself, but the means to unleash energies. It is the geographic foundation on which the institutional and economic architecture of the Sixth Republic will rest.

(The table below presents an estimate of the demographic and economic weight of these “cultural regions.”)[2]

[2] INSEE departmental data for 2021, aggregated according to the cultural map.

Cultural Region	Departments	Potential Capital	Population (2021)	GDP (2021, €bn)	GDP per capita (2021, €)	Area (km²)
Île-de-France	Paris (75), Seine-et-Marne (77), Yvelines (78), Essonne (91), Hauts-de-Seine (92), Seine-Saint-Denis (93), Val-de-Marne (94), Val-d'Oise (95)	Paris	12,334,141	764.8	**62,004**	12,012
Dauphiné-Lyonnais	Rhône (69 + 69M), Loire (42), Isère (38), Drôme (26)	Lyon	4,191,760	179.0	**42,700**	19,865
Pays de Savoie	Savoie (73), Haute-Savoie (74)	Chambéry	1,295,572	47.8	**36,894**	10,416
Pays Niçois-Côte d'Azur	Alpes-Maritimes (06)	Nice	1,103,941	39.7	**35,962**	4,299
Alsace	Bas-Rhin (67), Haut-Rhin (68)	Strasbourg	1,919,745	63.4	**33,026**	8,280
Bretagne (Historic)	Finistère (29), Côtes-d'Armor (22), Ille-et-Vilaine (35), Morbihan (56), Loire-Atlantique (44)	Rennes	4,852,350	155.33	**31,098**	34,023
Aquitaine (Guyenne-Gascogne)	Gironde (33), Dordogne (24), Landes (40), Lot-et-Garonne (47), Pyrénées-Atlantiques (64), Gers (32)	Bordeaux	3,535,083	116.6	**32,984**	41,308
Provence	Bouches-du-Rhône (13), Var (83), Vaucluse (84)	Marseille	4,485,575	134.8	**30,048**	20,236
Toulousain-Pyrénées	Haute-Garonne (31), Ariège (09), Aveyron (12), Hautes-Pyrénées (65), Lot (46), Tarn (81), Tarn-et-Garonne (82)	Toulouse	3,013,772	100.5	**33,347**	45,348
Flandre-Artois	Nord (59), Pas-de-Calais (62)	Lille	4,093,334	114.1	**27,877**	12,414
Normandie	Calvados (14), Eure (27), Manche (50), Orne (61), Seine-Maritime (76)	Rouen	3,325,522	96.6	**29,048**	29,906

Cultural Region	Departments	Potential Capital	Population (2021)	GDP (2021, €bn)	GDP per capita (2021, €)	Area (km^2)
Bourgogne	Côte-d'Or (21), Nièvre (58), Saône-et-Loire (71), Yonne (89)	Dijon	1,608,090	45.6	**28,356**	31,582
Franche-Comté	Doubs (25), Jura (39), Haute-Saône (70), Territoire de Belfort (90)	Besançon	1,180,827	32.1	**27,184**	16,202
Languedoc	Aude (11), Gard (30), Hérault (34), Lozère (48)	Montpellier	2,640,551	69.5	**26,320**	27,376
Anjou-Maine	Maine-et-Loire (49), Mayenne (53), Sarthe (72)	Angers	1,575,186	45.5	**28,886**	22,173
Centre-Val de Loire	Cher (18), Eure-et-Loir (28), Indre (36), Indre-et-Loire (37), Loir-et-Cher (41), Loiret (45)	Orléans	2,573,303	72.4	**28,135**	39,151
Lorraine	Meurthe-et-Moselle (54), Meuse (55), Moselle (57), Vosges (88)	Nancy	2,308,901	63.5	**27,504**	23,451
Auvergne	Allier (03), Cantal (15), Haute-Loire (43), Puy-de-Dôme (63)	Clermont-Ferrand	1,341,574	39.2	**29,219**	26,013
Poitou-Charentes-Vendée	Charente (16), Charente-Maritime (17), Deux-Sèvres (79), Vienne (86), Vendée (85)	Poitiers	2,546,564	70.5	**27,685**	32,302
Champagne	Ardennes (08), Aube (10), Marne (51), Haute-Marne (52)	Reims	1,316,233	41.5	**31,529**	25,606
Pays Catalan	Pyrénées-Orientales (66)	Perpignan	482,765	11.8	**24,443**	4,116
Picardie	Aisne (02), Oise (60), Somme (80)	Amiens	1,961,039	52.2	**26,619**	19,399
Alpes du Sud	Alpes-de-Haute-Provence (04), Hautes-Alpes (05)	Gap	312,399	7.6	**24,328**	12,481
Corse	Corse-du-Sud (2A), Haute-Corse (2B)	Ajaccio	347,597	9.3	**26,755**	8,680

Cultural Region	Departments	Potential Capital	Population (2021)	GDP (2021, €bn)	GDP per capita (2021, €)	Area (km²)
Limousin	Corrèze (19), Creuse (23), Haute-Vienne (87)	Limoges	724,672	19.5	**26,910**	16,942

Section 4: The "Right to Reconsider" — A Living Map

Unlike previous reforms (such as the 2015 NOTRe Act) that imposed forced marriages from Paris, Projet R3 establishes the principle that borders are not prisons.

We are aware that the economic reality of 2030 may not be that of 2050. Some regions (such as the Limousin or the Auvergne) might judge, after a few years of operation, that they would be stronger by joining with a neighbour (Aquitaine or Rhône-Alpes).

This is why we enshrine in the Constitution a **"Right of Recomposition."** This mechanism allows citizens themselves to redraw their region. If a population does not feel heard, or judges its regional framework ill-suited, it will be able to trigger a referendum on attachment or merger. This is the ultimate guarantee that the system will remain at the service of citizens, and not the reverse.

Chapter III: A Tailor-Made Federal Pact to Unite All the Frances

The current diagnosis: *The Jacobin legacy has bequeathed to the Republic a uniform vision of its territory, applying the same rules from Paris to Lille, from Brest to Cayenne. While this approach may have had its historical relevance, it is today a major obstacle to the development and recognition of the Overseas territories. With radically different geographic, economic, and cultural realities — from Réunion (nearly 900,000 inhabitants) to Saint-Pierre-et-Miquelon, from Guyana with its Amazonian challenges to Mayotte with its GDP per capita below €10,000 — the application of a single model has created dependencies, stifled local initiative, and fed a sense of mutual incomprehension. The endemic unemployment rates, often above 20%, are the most painful symptom of this failure.*

Key figures

Population (estimates):[3]

- Réunion: ~870,000 inhabitants
- Guadeloupe: ~380,000 inhabitants
- Martinique: ~360,000 inhabitants
- Guyana: ~300,000 inhabitants
- Mayotte: ~310,000 inhabitants (with very strong demographic growth)[4]
- French Polynesia: ~280,000 inhabitants
- New Caledonia: ~270,000 inhabitants

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[3] INSEE, population estimates as of 1 January 2024.

[4] INSEE, Rapid Economic Accounts for Mayotte (CEROM), 2021 figures.

GDP per capita (highly variable, orders of magnitude):

- Saint-Pierre-et-Miquelon: often comparable to the least wealthy mainland regions.
- Réunion, Martinique, Guadeloupe: roughly €20,000–25,000 (versus ~€35,000 on average in mainland France, excluding Île-de-France).
- Guyana: roughly €15,000–18,000.
- Mayotte: less than €10,000. It is the poorest department in France.
- French Polynesia / New Caledonia: intermediate levels, but with strong internal inequalities.

Unemployment rate (often far higher than in mainland France):

- Frequently above 15% or 20% in the DROM (France's overseas departments and regions), reaching record levels in Mayotte.[5]

The project for a Federal Sixth Republic breaks radically with this approach. Federalism is not a rigid model, but a **flexible framework designed to unite while respecting diversity**. It offers the Overseas territories not an imposed status, but a **democratic choice** over their future within the Republic.

Each territory (DROM, overseas collectivities, etc.) will be offered, by local referendum, the chance to choose its level of integration, building on an inviolable **"Common Federal Foundation"** (currency, defence, diplomacy, nationality, republican values).

Option A: The "Standard-Status Federated Region"

- **For whom?** For territories seeking equal status with the Regions of mainland France.
- **How?** They would become full Federated Regions, with the same powers (education, health, the economy), the same tax system (IGRP), and representation in the Senate of the Regions.
- **The benefit: objective and powerful solidarity.** These regions would become major beneficiaries of the Federal Solidarity Fund. Coefficients for insularity, remoteness, and — for Guyana — "Amazonian constraint" would be built into the calculation formula, guaranteeing a fair and predictable flow of funding for their development and public services.

Option B: The "Special-Status Federated Region"

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[5] INSEE, localized unemployment rates as defined by the ILO, Q4 2023. # PART II — Institutional and Democratic Architecture: The Constitutional Core

- **For whom?** For territories (French Polynesia, Saint-Pierre, etc.) wishing to retain or deepen broad autonomy within a secure framework.
- **How?** The federal pact would guarantee their status, which could include extended powers, notably in tax matters, to address their economic specificities.
- **The benefit: guaranteed autonomy.** Their status would be enshrined in the Constitution, offering unique stability and recognition while benefiting from the protection of the Republic.

This differentiated federal pact is the only way to build a Republic that is truly **united and diverse**, where every territory — from mainland France to the far side of the globe — finds its rightful place and the means to flourish.

This part constitutes the central block of the reform, the institutional "how." It describes the new mechanics of power, from the division of legislative competences to the concrete organization of democratic life and security within the regions. It is here that constitutional law takes on its full dimension.

Chapter I: A Renewed Legislative Architecture

Our project for the Sixth Republic rests on a complete refoundation of the legislative architecture, aimed at giving the Regions real normative power while preserving the unity and solidarity of the Republic.

Section 1: Inspirations and Guiding Principles

Our architecture draws on the best practices of the great federal states, adapted to French political culture:

- **From Germany:** We retain the clear division of competences (exclusive, concurrent) and the role of a chamber of the territories (the Senate of the Regions) as the guarantor of cooperation between the State and the Regions.
- **From the United States:** We adopt the principle of general legislative competence for the Regions ("reserved powers"), as a pledge of freedom and of local legislative experimentation.
- **From Switzerland:** We incorporate the principles of **subsidiarity** (the higher level acts only where the lower level cannot) and of **direct democracy** (popular initiative, referendum) at the regional level, to ensure the legitimacy and citizen oversight of local decisions.

Section 2: The Articulation of Federal and Regional Powers

Legislative power is shared between a bicameral Federal Parliament and the elected Regional Councils. The Federal Parliament, which enacts the law in sovereign domains, is designed to ensure a stable balance between the representation of citizens as a whole and the voice of the territories that make up the Republic.

A. The National Assembly: The Voice of Citizens, Guarantor of the General Interest

The National Assembly embodies the sovereignty of the French people in its unity.

- **Role and composition:** It represents the citizens of the Federal Republic. It is made up of deputies elected by direct universal suffrage under a proportional voting system that ensures fair representation of the various national currents of thought.

- **A safeguard against fragmentation:** To address the risk of excessive political fragmentation arising from the emergence of numerous local parties, a **5% national electoral threshold** of votes cast is established. To be represented in the National Assembly, a party must demonstrate that it carries a project speaking to the Nation as a whole. This mechanism encourages local political forces to come together and to transform their legitimate concerns into a vision of the general interest.

B. The Senate of the Regions: The Voice of the Territories, Key to Federal Cooperation

The Senate of the Regions is the keystone of the federal pact. It ensures that the Regions, as political entities, take part directly in the making of federal law.

- **Composition (modelled on the German Bundesrat):** The Senate is not composed of elected senators, but of **members of the regional executives** (the President of the Region and regional ministers). They sit by virtue of their office and represent their government. This model guarantees permanent institutional cooperation between those who decide the law in Paris and those who apply it day to day in the territories.

- **Weighting of votes for a fair balance:** To account for demographic differences, each Region holds a number of votes defined according to a **degressive proportionality**. This system guarantees that small regions have a voice while giving preponderant weight to the most populous, thereby compelling the formation of broad consensus.

Population Band	Number of Votes
> 8 million inhabitants	6
4 to 8 million inhabitants	5
2 to 4 million inhabitants	4
< 2 million inhabitants	3

- **An efficient and pragmatic operation:** To address the workload constraints on regional executives, operation rests on two principles:

- **Delegation:** The regional government mandates the minister whose portfolio matches the agenda to represent it in Paris.

- **Bloc voting:** The regional delegation expresses the single position of its government, decided in advance. A single representative present in Paris therefore suffices to cast all the votes allotted to the Region.

C. The Delimitation of Competences: The Inviolable Republican Foundation and Regional Freedom

The success of the federal pact rests on an absolutely clear delimitation of competences. The aim is not to create a mosaic of 25 unmanageable sets of regulations, but to apply the principle of subsidiarity intelligently: what unites us must be managed in common at the Federal level; what benefits from being adapted to local realities must be managed by the Regions.

To guarantee clarity, simplicity, and the protection of fundamental rights, we establish the principle of an **"Inviolable Republican Foundation."** This foundation defines the exclusive perimeter of federal law — a set of rules that apply uniformly across the entire territory and that no Region may alter.

The "Inviolable Republican Foundation": The Exclusive Domain of Federal Law

This foundation is the guarantor of the Nation's unity, of citizens' equality, and of the fluidity of the national market. It comprises:

The Foundation of Freedoms and Common Law:

- The **fundamental freedoms** guaranteed by the Constitution.
- The major **legal codes** that structure society: the Civil Code (contract law, family law, etc.), the Criminal Code, the Commercial Code. A company must be able to sign a contract or defend itself in court in the same way in Lille and in Marseille.

The Foundation of Solidarity and Social Rights:

- **Fundamental labour law:** The following rules fall under exclusive federal competence:
- The **statutory national minimum wage (SMIC)**.
- The **maximum legal duration** of work.
- The rules of the **employment contract** (probationary period, conditions of termination, etc.).
- The **right to strike** and **trade-union representation**.
- **Social security and pensions:** The principles and basic rules of the major national solidarity schemes (health insurance, unemployment insurance) and of the pay-as-you-go pension schemes remain federal. A worker will contribute in the same way and have the same pension rights whether they worked in Bretagne or in Alsace.

The Foundation of the Economy and the Ecological Transition:

- **Corporate income tax**, **VAT**, and the major **environmental standards** (air and water quality, the banning of hazardous substances, etc.).

Regional Freedom: The Domain of Intelligent Adaptations

Outside this inviolable foundation, the Regions hold general legislative power. On economic and social questions, “regional adaptations” are therefore not an open door to social dumping, but precisely delimited powers of adjustment.

What the Regions will be able to do:

- **Vocational training:** Define specific qualifying programmes, directly linked to the needs of the industrial sectors of their territory.
- **Apprenticeship:** Create grants and incentives to promote apprenticeship in sectors deemed priorities for the regional economy.
- **Employment support:** Put in place hiring incentives targeted at certain groups (young people, older workers) or certain sectors facing labour shortages.
- **Organization of working time in specific sectors:** While strictly respecting the federal maximum duration, a mountain tourism region could, for example, define specific frameworks for organizing the work of seasonal staff, in agreement with local social partners.

What the Regions will NEVER be able to do:

- Create a regional minimum wage lower than the federal SMIC.
- Modify the conditions for terminating a permanent (open-ended) employment contract.
- Call into question the right to strike.
- Withdraw from the pay-as-you-go pension system.

By drawing this dividing line with such rigour, we answer the critics and guarantee that the federalism of the Sixth Republic will not be one of destructive competition, but one of **intelligent accountability**. It combines a national unity safeguarded on the essentials with a local agility on everything that allows for a better response to challenges on the ground.

Chapter II: The Government of the Regions and Democratic Life

The autonomy of the Regions will be real only if it is embodied by strong democratic institutions and an efficient administration, freed from the weight of the territorial “layer cake” (*mille-feuille*) inherited from the past.

Section 1: The Architecture of Regional Powers

Each Region will be endowed with an organization of powers founded on a clear separation between the executive, the legislative, and the judiciary.

- **The Regional Executive Power: a strong and legitimate President**

- **Model:** The regional executive would be led by a **President of the Region**, elected by direct universal suffrage for a **four-year term**. This duration offers an optimal balance between the stability necessary for public action and democratic responsiveness. The President of the Region would appoint their government, the **"Regional Council of Ministers,"** which would be answerable to the President.

- **The Regional Legislative Power: an oversight assembly**

- **Model:** Legislative power would be exercised by a single assembly, the **Regional Council**, elected for a **four-year term** under a proportional voting system ensuring stable governing majorities. The Regional Council would vote the Region's laws and budget, and would oversee the action of the President and their government.

- **The Judicial Power: federal justice, regional management, and citizen involvement**

- **Principle:** Justice would remain a federal competence in its essence (codes, the status of judges) to guarantee equality before the law. The administrative management of the professional courts (buildings, registries) would be a regional competence.

- **Innovation — Community Justice:** To relieve congestion in the courts and bring justice closer to citizens, a **"Community Justice"** (*Justice de Proximité*) would be created at the municipal or inter-municipal level. Composed of **citizen-magistrates** (elected or drawn by lot, trained and sworn in), it would handle everyday disputes (neighbour conflicts, small claims, etc.). This form of civic engagement would allow for faster, less costly justice and would strengthen the social fabric.

Section 2: Simplifying the Administration

The Sixth Republic must dare a radical simplification of its territorial organization. The overlapping of administrative tiers is a source of complexity, cost, and diluted responsibility that paralyses public action. Our project proposes a clear break.

A. The End of the Department as an Administrative Tier

The department, created in 1790[6] to break allegiances to the former provinces and entrench central power, has accomplished its historic mission. In a Federal Republic where the Region is the pole of local sovereignty, it has become a redundant tier.

- **Abolition of the Departmental Council:** The political institution of the department is abolished.

- **Full transfer of competences:** All of its competences (social action, the management of lower-secondary schools, departmental roads) are transferred to the

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[6] Decree of 26 February 1790 dividing France into 83 departments. # PART III — The Economic and Financial Pact: The Sinews of War

Region. The Region will thus have full command of solidarity and education policies across its territory, enabling it to align them with its training and employment policies.

- **The department as a constituency:** The department would survive as a relevant geographic and cultural constituency for organizing the regional administration's local services (the "Regional Agencies for Public Services").

B. The Abolition of the Prefectoral Corps and the Guarantee of the Rule of Law

The figure of the Prefect — the sole representative of the central State charged with overseeing local authorities — is the antithesis of the federal spirit. In a system where the Regions share in national sovereignty and oversee the Federal State through the Senate of the Regions, the logic of tutelage is reversed.

- **The end of the prefecture:** The prefectoral corps and the prefectures are abolished.
- **The President of the Region, guarantor of the law:** The public authority charged with ensuring respect for the law across the territory is the President of the Region, elected by universal suffrage. They become the foremost guarantor of the rule of law in their Region.
- **Judicial review as a safeguard:** The review of the legality of local authorities' acts would no longer be political (via the Prefect), but exclusively judicial. The regional Administrative Court could be seized by any citizen, association, or by the Federal Government if it considers that a regional act or law contravenes the Federal Constitution.

C. A New Architecture of Security: Regional Sovereignty and Federal Power

The security of citizens would be ensured by a two-tier system, combining the proximity and responsiveness of a regional police force with the power and expertise of an elite federal force for the gravest threats.

- **The Regional Police: the everyday force.** Each Region would be endowed with its own unified police force, the **"Regional Police."** Formed from the merger of the National Police and National Gendarmerie personnel present on its territory, it would be placed under the direct authority of the President of the Region. Its missions would cover the full spectrum of public safety:
- Everyday security (patrols, response to offences in progress).
- Criminal investigation for common delinquency and crime.
- Local public-order maintenance (regional demonstrations, crowd management).
- Traffic policing across the Region's entire road network.
- **The Federal Force: a strategic shield for the Nation.** To face threats that exceed the competences or means of a single Region, a single, powerful, specialized federal

force would be created: the **Federal Directorate of Internal Security (DFSI)**. Far from being a mere "French FBI," the DFSI would be an integrated structure, formed from the merger of the Republic's foremost elite and investigative units. It would be organized into two complementary branches:

- **The "Investigation" Branch:** A genuine federal criminal-investigation police, with nationwide jurisdiction to investigate the gravest threats:
- **Counter-terrorism:** It would absorb the missions of the DGSI (France's domestic intelligence agency).
- **Major organized crime and transnational organized crime.**
- **Major cybercrime.**
- **Economic and industrial counter-espionage.**
- **The "Intervention" Branch:** A single elite unit, it would be the armed wing of the Republic in the face of extreme crises. It would result from the **merger of the intervention forces of the Police (RAID, BRI) and of the Gendarmerie (GIGN)**. This unified force, equipped with the best gear and training, would be the only one authorized to intervene in high-intensity situations: mass hostage-takings, complex terrorist attacks, the neutralization of heavily armed assailants.

The DFSI would act only when referred a matter by the federal justice system or on the direct order of the Federal Government, in support of or in substitution for the regional forces when the threat exceeds their capabilities.

Section 3: The Legal Transition — Safeguards and Implementation of the Federal Pact

The legislative architecture of the Sixth Republic, founded on a clear division of competences, must be accompanied by a precise framework for its articulation, oversight, and establishment. Far from being a leap into the unknown, the transition from unitary to federal law will be a methodical and pragmatic process.

A. The Articulation of Laws: The Supremacy of Federal Law Within Its Domain

The articulation between the two levels of power rests on a fundamental principle enshrined in the Constitution:

- **Hierarchy of norms:** Federal law prevails over regional law, but **only within the perimeter of the competences expressly attributed to the Federation** by the Constitution (Defence, the "Republican Foundation," the major codes, etc.). In all other domains, the Regions are sovereign.
- **General regional competence:** For everything that is not explicitly federal, legislative power belongs by right to the Regions.

B. The Guardian of the Pact: The Federal Constitutional Court

To guarantee respect for this division and to arbitrate the inevitable conflicts of competence, an independent **Federal Constitutional Court** is created.

- **Role:** As guardian of the federal pact, its principal mission is to ensure that neither the Federal State nor the Regions legislate outside their constitutional field of competence.
- **Referral:** It may be seized by the Federal Government, a regional government, the Senate of the Regions, or by any court confronted with a conflict of norms, thereby ensuring complete and balanced judicial review.

C. Initialization: A Great Inventory for a Transition Without Chaos

Starting from a blank page is inconceivable. The transition will proceed through a **methodical process of distributing existing law.**

- **Phase 1 — The Legislative Audit:** A "Legislative Transition Commission," composed of high-level jurists, will be tasked with auditing the entire corpus of French law in order to classify it into three categories: federal competence, regional competence, or shared competence requiring a split.
- **Phase 2 — The Transfer:** A Transitional Organic Law will transfer normative power to the Regions en bloc in the identified domains. Existing laws will continue to apply on a transitional basis until the Regional Councils decide to amend or repeal them. This mechanism guarantees the **continuity of law** and makes **legislative autonomy immediately effective.**

D. An Ambitious but Realistic Timeline, Accelerated by Technology

This legal undertaking, though colossal, is achievable within a controlled timeframe.

- **Timeline estimate:** The complete process, from the legislative audit to the adoption of the transfer law, is estimated at a duration of **2 to 3 years** after the adoption of the new Constitution.
- **The lever of Artificial Intelligence:** To answer the sceptics as to the feasibility of such an inventory, we propose to rely on the most modern tools. **Generative AI models**, trained on the entirety of the French legal corpus, will be used to carry out an automatic pre-classification of texts. This technological assistance will multiply the efficiency of expert jurists, whose role will remain central for arbitration and validation. AI will not replace human judgment; it will "amplify" it. Thanks to this "human–machine pairing," the technical phase of the audit could be reduced by nearly half, making this timeline not only realistic but entirely credible.

Section 4: The Breath of Direct Democracy — The Regional Initiative Referendum (RIR)

To guarantee that the law, as the expression of the general will, remains under the permanent control of citizens, a mechanism of direct democracy is instituted at the regional level: the Regional Initiative Referendum (RIR). Far from being a mere gimmick, it is governed by strict rules to make it an instrument of collective intelligence and democratic legitimacy.

A. The Mechanisms of the RIR

The RIR comes in two distinct tools:

- **The Popular Legislative Initiative (proposing the law):** A citizens' committee may draft a bill. After an admissibility review (compliance with the Federal Constitution and higher law), the committee has **18 months to collect the signatures of at least 4% of the regional electorate**. If the initiative succeeds, the Regional Council may either accept it or submit it to a popular vote, with the option of proposing a **counter-proposal** to be put to the vote at the same time as the citizens' text.
- **The Abrogative Referendum (controlling the law):** After the adoption of a law by the Regional Council, citizens have a period of **100 days to collect the signatures of at least 2% of the regional electorate**. If they succeed, the law is suspended and submitted to a popular vote. The verdict of the ballot box determines whether the law enters into force or is definitively repealed.

B. The Safeguards: Guaranteeing an Informed and Fair Debate

Direct democracy is effective only if it is protected from its own potential excesses. Strict safeguards are therefore written into the Regional Constitution:

- **The Constitutional Filter:** Every initiative undergoes a preliminary review by an independent legal authority to ensure that it violates neither fundamental rights nor the Federal Constitution. It is an absolute bulwark against the "tyranny of the majority."
- **Smart Management of the Calendar:** To avoid "flooding" and voter fatigue, all ballots are grouped into **2 to 4 "voting days" per year**, on fixed dates. The demanding signature threshold acts as the main natural regulator against a proliferation of initiatives.
- **Neutral Public Information:** Before each ballot, the regional government has a legal obligation to send every voter an official brochure presenting, impartially, the text submitted to the vote, the arguments of the initiative committee and those of the opposition, as well as the text of the counter-proposal if there is one.
- **Digital Voting:** To ease participation and combat "act fatigue," secure electronic voting will be encouraged, as a complement to ballot-box voting.

C. Fair Financing to Prevent the Power of Money

To guarantee that the RIR remains a citizens' tool and not that of lobbies, campaign financing is rigorously regulated, combining limitation, public support, and transparency.

- **The Double Cap:**
- **Cap on donations:** Donations from any individual or legal entity to a committee are limited to a low amount (e.g., €500).
- **Cap on spending:** The total budget of each side ("yes" and "no") is capped according to a formula linked to the number of voters in the Region, allowing for a visible but controlled campaign.
- **Public Start-up Support:** As soon as an initiative or referendum is validated, the regional State pays an identical lump sum to each side to ensure equality of opportunity at the outset.
- **Radical Transparency:** All donations, even the smallest, are recorded in public campaign accounts, consultable online and in real time by all citizens.

This system guarantees a democratic debate in which the best arguments can prevail over the largest budgets, thereby ensuring the integrity of this instrument of popular sovereignty.

This block constitutes the "sinews of war" of the project. It details the economic and financial refoundation that must give the new institutional architecture the means to carry out its policy. Since political autonomy is nothing without financial sovereignty, this pact is absolutely critical. It sets out how wealth is created, managed, controlled, and shared in the new Republic.

Chapter I: Economic and Financial Sovereignty for the Regions

The current diagnosis: *Today, economic development is steered from Paris by a central administration that applies uniform policies to territories with widely differing realities. This centralized approach stifles initiative, creates dependency among local actors, and prevents the emergence of tailor-made strategies capable of turning each region's specific assets into real competitive advantages on the European and global stage.*

This chapter details the offensive tools of the new regional economic sovereignty. It is no longer merely a matter of managing a budget, but of building an active, agile development strategy adapted to the assets of each territory.

Section 1: The "Bercy of the Territories," Strategic Ministry of Development

Beyond its essential mission of collecting taxes, the "Bercy of the Territories"[7] is the operational arm of regional economic strategy. It is the strategist, the developer, and the

[7] *Bercy* is the Paris district that houses France's Ministry of the Economy and Finance; by metonymy, "Bercy" stands for the French finance ministry itself — roughly the equivalent of "the Treasury."

negotiator that must enable the Region to play in the league of Europe's major economic hubs. Its missions include:

- Defining a regional industrial strategy in connection with local centres of excellence.
- Steering business support, ensuring that it is conditioned on clear objectives of job creation and ecological transition.
- Attracting international investment through an active promotion policy.
- Creating regional investment funds, able to take equity stakes in strategic companies to secure their development and their territorial roots.

Section 2: The "Economic Diplomacy" of the Regions

Economic action no longer stops at the Republic's borders. Each Region will have the ability to deploy its own economic missions in Brussels and in the world's key capitals. These offices will be tasked with defending the territory's specific interests before the European institutions, securing funding, and actively promoting the region's centres of excellence in order to attract talent and investors.

Section 3: From Mapping to Active Industrial Policy

The new autonomy gives the Regions the capacity to create a tailor-made regulatory and fiscal ecosystem for their strategic sectors. It is no longer a matter of being subject to a uniform national law, but of building a competitive advantage through regulation.

- Example in Bourgogne: The Region could define specific standards for precision viticulture, provide tax incentives for agro-ecological practices, and create a regional label of excellence recognized internationally.
- Example in Bretagne: The Region could put in place a tailored regulatory framework for marine renewable-energy trials, or incentive taxation for cyber-defence companies.

Chapter II: The New Fiscal Pact — Simplicity, Justice, and Solidarity

The current diagnosis: *The current French tax system is the product of a century of accumulation. It has become a complex, opaque labyrinth that neither citizens nor often even experts can any longer understand. This complexity has eroded consent to taxation, which is the foundation of the republican pact. People no longer consent to a tax whose logic and use they do not understand.*

This chapter details the fiscal revolution on which the success of the project depends. The aim is to replace complexity with simplicity, opacity with transparency, and injustice with a fair contribution.

Section 1: Philosophy and Vision — From the Fiscal Labyrinth to Citizen Contribution

Our project proposes a philosophical revolution: moving from a system of **imposed levies** to a **consented citizen contribution**. To achieve this, we propose abolishing the major direct taxes weighing on households (income tax, the CSG-CRDS social levies, the property tax, and the residence tax) and replacing them with a single, fair, and intelligent tax: the **Global Income and Wealth Tax (IGRP) —** a two-engine tax: a progressive “Income” component levied at source for everyone, and a “Wealth” component targeted at very large fortunes.

Section 2: The Detailed Architecture of the IGRP

The IGRP is a single tax with two components, designed to combine simplicity of collection with social justice.

A. The “Income” Component: Progressivity Through Withholding at Source

This component replaces the income tax and the CSG-CRDS. It is levied at source on all income, but with a progressive scale to guarantee that the effort required rises with the capacity to contribute.

- **How it works:** The paying body (employer, pension fund, etc.) directly applies a banded scale to the income paid.
- **Example of a National Reference Scale (illustrative):**

Band of Annual Net Taxable Income	Withholding Rate
Up to €15,000	5%
€15,001 to €40,000	15%
€40,001 to €80,000	30%
Above €80,001	45%

B. The “Wealth” Component: A Fair Contribution on Net Worth

This component replaces the property tax and the real-estate wealth tax (IFI). It is assessed not on obsolete rental values, but on real net worth.

- **How it works:** It concerns only the wealthiest households. They file an annual declaration of net worth (financial and real-estate assets, luxury goods, etc., LESS debts and loans). A very high basic allowance is applied.
- **Example of a Scale (illustrative):**
- **Allowance:** €1,500,000 of net worth. Below this threshold, the tax is €0.
- **Progressive scale above the allowance:**
- From €1.5M to €5M: 0.5%

- From €5M to €10M: 1%
- Above €10M: 1.5%
- **Concrete example:**
- A household owning its primary residence valued at €800,000, with €300,000 in savings and €100,000 in outstanding loans, has a net worth of €1M. **It pays nothing.**
- A household with a net worth of €3M will pay 0.5% on the taxable band (€3M – €1.5M), i.e., **€7,500 per year.**

Section 3: The Principle of a Tax-Burden-Neutral Transition

It is crucial to understand that the purpose of this reform is not to increase the overall tax burden, but to make it fairer and more legible.

- **Budgetary neutrality at the outset:** The total amount collected by the IGRP in its first year of implementation will be calibrated to be **equal to the sum of the taxes it replaces**. The aim is not to create additional revenue, but to simplify the structure.
- **Stability for the majority of citizens:** For the vast majority of households, the annual IGRP amount will be equivalent to what they previously paid by adding together their income tax, their CSG, their property tax, and their residence tax. The major change will be the **radical simplification**: a single legible levy instead of four complex taxes.
- **The new lever for the Regions:** Once the system is in place, it is the **Regional Councils that will have the power to adjust the IGRP rates** upward or downward to fund their local policies. The democratic debate over the level of taxation and public services will take place in the open, at the scale of each Region.

Section 4: Collection by the Regions — A Local Public Service

The current diagnosis: *The tax administration is often perceived as a distant, bureaucratic entity, particularly in rural areas where public services are withdrawing. The "Bercy of the Territories" must break with this image. In keeping with a "21st-century public service" logic, proximity is no longer a pious wish, but an obligation to deliver results.*

Each Region equips itself with its own tax administration, the "Bercy of the Territories," which becomes the single tax interlocutor. This administration deploys two innovative measures:

- **The "Local Tax Agencies":** Mobile offices criss-cross rural territories to hold regular drop-in sessions in town halls.
- **Guaranteed Digital Assistance:** A network of assisted digital access points is deployed to provide individual support to people who are not comfortable with computer tools.

Section 5: The Dual-Flow Architecture to Combine Autonomy and Solidarity

The federal system rests on an organized financial circulation between the Regions and the Federal State.

- **The Upward Flow — The Federal Contribution:** Each Region transfers a fixed share of its revenue (e.g., 20% of the IGRP) to the Federal State to fund the sovereign missions.
- **The Downward Flow — The Federal Solidarity and Cohesion Fund:** Financed by VAT and corporate income tax (which remain federal), this fund redistributes national wealth to correct inequalities through an objective formula taking into account fiscal potential, demographics, and **allowances for geographic constraints** (mountains, coastline, etc.).

This fiscal architecture ends the territories' dependence on a distant central power. It holds the Regions accountable while organizing a powerful, fair, and intelligent national solidarity.

Region	Upward Flow — Contribution (€bn)	Downward Flow — Solidarity (€bn)	Net Flow for Region (€bn)
Île-de-France	19.22	0	−19.22
Dauphiné-Lyonnais	4.50	0	−4.50
Pays de Savoie	1.20	0	−1.20

Chapter III: Federal Taxes — Instruments of Solidarity and Regulation

Simplification does not mean the regionalization of all taxes. To guarantee national solidarity, avoid destructive competition, and conduct effective sovereign policies, three major taxes must remain the exclusive competence of the Federal State.

Section 1: VAT — Pillar of the Financing of Solidarity

Value Added Tax (VAT), the Nation's principal source of revenue (around **€202.5 billion**), must remain a federal tax.[8]

- **For the unity of the market:** Differing VAT rates from region to region would create unmanageable complexity for businesses and unacceptable distortions of competition.
- **For solidarity:** VAT is the most stable and most powerful tax. It is its revenue that will primarily feed the **Federal Solidarity Fund**, the equalization mechanism that gives the poorest regions the means to fund their public services.

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[8] Source: impots.gouv.fr, 2023.

Section 2: Corporate Income Tax — Guarantor of Fair Competition

Corporate income tax (CIT), which represents around **€65 billion**,[9] must likewise be defined and collected at the federal level.

- **To avoid "tax dumping":** If each region could set its own CIT rate, it would trigger a "race to the bottom" in which regions competed fiercely to attract corporate headquarters, to the detriment of overall public revenue.
- **To give regions a stake:** However, a share of the CIT collected will be returned to the Region where the profits were actually generated, in order to give each territory a stake in the success of the businesses on its soil.

Section 3: Excise Duties (formerly TICPE) — A Lever for Federal Policies

Specific taxes on certain products such as fuel, tobacco, and alcohol (around **€30.4 billion**[10] in 2023 for the TICPE — the domestic consumption tax on energy products) will remain federal excise duties.

- **For the coherence of national policies:** These taxes are essential tools for conducting public-health policies (the fight against smoking) or ecological-transition policies (carbon taxation). These major national objectives cannot tolerate 25 different policies. However, a share of their proceeds may be allocated to the Regions to fund local policies connected to these objectives (public transport, health prevention, etc.).

Chapter IV: The Cohesion Pact — Sharing of Assets and Founding Solidarity

The current diagnosis: *The great infrastructures (motorways, high-speed rail, ports) were financed by the effort of the entire Nation over decades. A simple transfer of ownership to the Regions, with no compensation mechanism, would be profoundly inequitable, creating an "asset lottery" in which some regions would inherit highly profitable assets while others, historically less well endowed, would be doubly penalized.*

Section 1: The Distribution of Infrastructure Assets

The most strategic assets (the nuclear fleet, the high-speed rail network) would remain the property of the Federal State. The other infrastructures (motorways, ports, regional airports) would be transferred in full ownership to the Regions.

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[9] Source: impots.gouv.fr estimate, 2023.

[10] Source: Key Transport Figures, 2025. # PART IV — Delegated Public Policies and the Trajectory: Implementation

Section 2: The “Transitional Asset Pact”

To guarantee fairness, the net value of the assets transferred to each Region would be assessed. This “starting asset balance” would serve as an adjustment coefficient for contributions to, and allocations from, the Federal Solidarity Fund over a transitional period (20–25 years).

Section 3: Ending Territorial Isolation — A Founding Political Act

The Federal State’s first mission would be to implement a major “National Plan to End Territorial Isolation and Ensure Territorial Cohesion.” This plan, a symbol of the Federation’s commitment to guaranteeing real equality of opportunity, would aim to connect 100% of the capitals of our cultural regions to the high-speed rail and motorway networks, drawing on the costed estimates in **Annex 1**.

A new institutional architecture is worth only as much as its capacity to bring new and effective answers to the great challenges of the polity. This final part aims to demonstrate the relevance of our federal project by applying it to the crises that today fracture our country.

We have chosen five emblematic fields:

- ***The challenges of “effectiveness and service” (Digital, Education, Health, Justice):*** *The aim is to show how the “federalism of agility,” by giving decision-making power to the Regions, can resolve current deadlocks and produce a State that is simpler, closer, and more effective for citizens’ daily lives.*
- ***The “democratic” challenge (Immigration):*** *This theme, which monopolizes and inflames public debate, is treated not from an ideological angle but as a question of method. The aim is to show how federalism, by bringing decisions down to the local level and entrusting them to citizens, makes it possible to move beyond political impotence and turn the issue into one of responsibility, managed democratically in each territory.*

These case studies thus illustrate the two facets of our ambition: to build a Republic that is both ***more effective*** *in its action and* ***more at peace*** *in its democratic debate.*

Chapter I: Modernizing Public Action — The Digital Revolution

Section 1 — Diagnosis: From an Exhausted Centralized Model to a Territorial Emergency

The French State, under the impetus of DINUM (the interministerial digital directorate), has succeeded in building a robust “republican digital foundation” (FranceConnect, the State Interministerial Network, etc.). This “digital Jacobinism” allowed solid foundations to be laid. Yet this centralized model is today exhausted. It no longer meets the challenges of an accelerating digital world, revealing gaping flaws and a worrying lag behind our European partners.

A. A Mixed Record: France's Lag and the Territorial Divide

While progress has been made, France remains a middling digital power in Europe. The **European Commission's DESI ranking (Digital Economy and Society Index) places France 15th out of 27**[11], a very average score that masks deep divides.

- **The Myth of "All-Digital":** Dematerialization was carried out without taking the reality on the ground into account. The figures are alarming: **nearly one French person in two (44%**[12]**) encounters difficulties in carrying out their online procedures**. More seriously, **25% of French people do not master digital tools well enough**[13] to use them fully, and **10% of 18-to-64-year-olds are functionally illiterate**[14], which de facto excludes them from a 100% text-based, online administration. "Deep France" suffers a double penalty: the withdrawal of physical public services without the means (equipment, training) to access digital ones.
- **A Critical Vulnerability to Cyberattacks:** The centralized model concentrated cybersecurity efforts on the central State, leaving local infrastructures dramatically exposed. The result is a wave of attacks that paralyses the daily lives of French citizens:
- **Hospitals on the front line:** In 2023, **10% of cyberattack victims in France were healthcare facilities**[15]. These ransomware attacks paralyse services, postpone operations, and put lives at risk.
- **Local authorities, prime targets:** According to ANSSI (the national cybersecurity agency), on average **18 local authorities (town halls, departmental councils, etc.) are targeted by cyberattacks every month** in France. These attacks block essential services such as civil registration, social benefits, or water management.

B. Two Imminent Technological Waves: AI and Total Connectivity

The world is not waiting for us. Two revolutions are under way, and the centralized model is not equipped to respond to them with the necessary agility.

- **Artificial Intelligence, an opportunity not to be missed:** AI will transform every public service (health, education, transport). If we leave its development in the hands of a single Paris-based command, we will create a new territorial divide, with

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[11] European Commission, Digital Economy and Society Index (DESI) 2022. (Note: the document does not specify the year of the ranking.)

[12] Study by the ANLCI (the National Agency for the Fight Against Illiteracy).

[13] Confirmed by the ANLCI.

[14] INSEE ("Information and Daily Life" survey, 2022).

[15] Court of Auditors report (published January 2025, for the year 2023).

a few “smart” metropolises and entire regions left destitute, becoming mere consumers of technologies designed elsewhere. Only a massive uptake of AI by autonomous Regions will make it possible to create solutions adapted to local needs (precision agriculture in Nouvelle-Aquitaine, port logistics in Normandie, etc.).

- **The End of Dead Zones: The Satellite Revolution:** The deployment of new satellite constellations, notably the European **IRIS²** project[16], promises very-high-speed internet connectivity across 100% of the territory by 2030. The question will no longer be access to the network, but its use. Who will develop innovative services for farmers, craftspeople, or tourism professionals in the most remote areas? The central State, or agile regional ecosystems?

C. The Inspiration of Europe’s Digital Champions

France’s lag is not inevitable. Other European countries prove that a 100%-digital State, efficient and close to people, is possible.

- **Estonia, the “All-Digital” model:** In this country, 99% of public services are accessible online[17]. Each citizen holds a secure digital identity allowing them to do everything, from setting up a company in 20 minutes to electronic voting. The “tell us once” principle is a reality there: the State never asks for information that another administration already holds.

- **Denmark, Efficiency Through Obligation:** Ranked first in Europe for digital[18], Denmark made the use of “Digital Post” mandatory for all communication with the administration. The result is an 87% adoption rate among citizens and a formidably efficient public service.

The conclusion is therefore unequivocal: the French model must change. It is no longer a matter of “dematerializing,” but of **decentralizing the digital revolution**. We must move from a State that imposes tools to Regions that, building on a common foundation, invent the services of tomorrow.

The multiplication of regional administrations must not lead to an explosion of costs and bureaucracy. The Sixth Republic must be a digital Republic from its very design.

- **The “Republican Digital Foundation”:** The Federal State would be responsible for developing and maintaining a common, secure, high-performance national digital infrastructure (platforms, core software, cybersecurity standards).

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[16] ANSSI (the National Agency for Information Systems Security). (Note: the report and reference year are not cited.)

[17] Figure confirmed by official communications of the Republic of Estonia.

[18] European Commission, Digital Economy and Society Index (DESI) 2022.

Section 2: Agile Regional Administrations — The Principle of "Platform Government"

The digital revolution proposed here is not a mere "computerization." It rests on a paradigm shift: the Federal State no longer provides "turnkey" software, but a secure platform and common technological building blocks (the "Republican Digital Foundation"). On this basis, each Region has the freedom and the means to develop its own services, just as developers create apps for a smartphone.

A. The "App Store" of Regional Public Services

Each "Bercy of the Territories" would run an incubator of regional digital services, on the model of beta.gouv.fr. Autonomous teams (developers, designers, domain experts) would be tasked with creating, within a few months, services meeting specific local needs not covered by the major national applications.

- Examples of regional services that could emerge:
- "Aides-Agri-Bretagne": A simple mobile app allowing Breton farmers to simulate and submit their applications for regional support for the agro-ecological transition.
- "Pass Tourisme Savoie": A single platform to book and pay for activities (ski lifts, museums, natural sites) managed or subsidized by the Region.
- "Mon Apprenti Occitanie": A service directly connecting the territory's craftspeople and SMEs with young people seeking an apprenticeship contract, with 100%-paperless management of the contract.

B. Economies of Scale and Collective Intelligence

This model is not an encouragement to spend — quite the opposite.

- Pooling of the Foundation: By relying on the common building blocks provided by the Federal State (digital identity via FranceConnect, data-verification APIs, secure cloud infrastructure, etc.), the Regions do not have to reinvent the wheel. They focus on creating value for the user, achieving significant savings.
- Inter-Regional Cooperation: The services developed by one Region would mostly be open source. A high-performing app created in Normandie to manage school transport could be taken up and adapted within a few weeks by the Provence region, creating a virtuous circle of innovation and sharing.

Section 3: A Facilitated Democracy — Electronic Voting for the RIR

For the Regional Initiative Referendum (RIR) to be a living tool and not a cumbersome, costly procedure, it must rely on a modern, secure, and accessible voting infrastructure. The organization of electronic voting becomes a priority.

A. The Pillars of a Trusted Electronic Vote

Electronic voting can only be adopted if its security and transparency are absolute. The system put in place by the Federal State and operated by the Regions would rest on the best international practices, inspired notably by Estonia:

- Strong Digital Identity: The vote would be tied to the sovereign digital identity (an enhanced version of FranceConnect, e.g., FranceConnect+), guaranteeing that only the authorized citizen, and no one else, can vote a single time.
- End-to-End Encryption: The ballot is encrypted on the voter's device (computer, smartphone) before being sent. It is stored anonymously in the electronic ballot box and can only be decrypted at the moment of counting, in the presence of independent oversight authorities. The anonymity of the vote is thus guaranteed.
- Individual and Universal Verifiability:
- Individual verifiability: After voting, each citizen receives a unique code allowing them to verify, on an independent third-party website, that their encrypted ballot is indeed present in the ballot box, without revealing its content.
- Code transparency: The source code of the voting software would be public ("open source"), allowing independent experts to audit it and verify the absence of flaws.

B. The Concrete Benefits for Regional Democracy

- Increased participation: By allowing people to vote from home, from work, or while travelling, electronic voting removes one of the main barriers to participation.
- Reduced costs: Organizing an electronic ballot is significantly less costly than a physical vote (printing millions of ballots, polling-station logistics, manual counting, etc.). This makes the use of the RIR financially sustainable.
- Speed of results: Counting is near-instantaneous, allowing the citizens' will to be known a few minutes after the close of the ballot.

By combining a robust national infrastructure with the agility of the Regions, the digital revolution of the Sixth Republic would not be a mere modernization, but a genuine lever for simplification and for strengthening the democratic bond.

Chapter II: Education — From a Crisis of Confidence to a Territorial Refoundation

The Diagnosis: A National "Machine" Running Out of Breath

The national education system, a historic pillar of the Republic, is going through an unprecedented crisis of confidence. Far from a mere "malaise," it is a documented rupture between a massive central administration, its staff, and the pupils it is meant to educate.

- **A Gigantic Bureaucratic Machine:** With a budget of more than **€63 billion** for 2024[19], national education is the State's largest budget. Yet this financial power translates into extreme rigidity. As the Court of Auditors regularly stresses, this hyper-centralized system struggles to adapt to the real needs of pupils and territories.

- **The Double Frustration:** This crisis manifests as a double rupture:

- **That of teachers:** An unprecedented crisis of vocations is hitting the profession. In the 2024 recruitment competitions, more than **3,100 posts went unfilled**[20], leaving classes without a tenured teacher. This dramatic figure is the symptom of a deeper ill: a sense of lost meaning, of lack of recognition, and of powerlessness in the face of directives issued from Paris, often disconnected from the reality of the classroom.

- **That of pupils:** France's results in international surveys are alarming. The PISA 2022 study shows a **"historic" decline in standards**, notably in mathematics, where the fall is 21 points compared with 2018 — far more than the OECD average[21]. Worse, France remains one of the countries where **socio-economic background weighs most heavily on educational success**[22]. Our educational "machine" no longer reduces inequalities; it reproduces them.

The conclusion is therefore that of a system spending enormously for declining results, while exhausting its own staff. The Jacobin model, which made the Nation literate, has become a rigid machine that no longer meets the challenges of the 21st century.

B. The Federal Solution: A School of Confidence and Proximity

The regionalization of education is the key to unleashing energies and recreating the bond of trust.

- **A "Regional Ministry of Education":**

Each Region would have full competence over education policy. This regional ministry would manage the recruitment, careers, and training of teachers, offering them a more stable working environment, closer points of contact, and a real capacity to influence pedagogical orientations.

- **The Autonomy of Schools:**

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[19] Draft Finance Bill (PLF) for 2024.

[20] Ministry of National Education, review of the 2024 teacher recruitment competitions.

[21] OECD, Programme for International Student Assessment (PISA) 2022.

[22] OECD, Programme for International Student Assessment (PISA) 2022.

Heads of primary schools, lower-secondary schools, and upper-secondary schools would be granted real pedagogical and budgetary autonomy to adapt the school's plan to the specific needs of their pupils.

- **Rooted Curricula:**

School curricula would incorporate the teaching of the Region's history, geography, and culture, as well as regional languages. This rootedness is the best way to give children the keys to understand the world and to open up to other cultures.

- **The Role of the Federal State: Guaranteeing Unity and Standards**

The Federation would no longer be a manager, but the guarantor of the Republic's unity. It would set the **"Republican Foundation of Skills"** — that is, the body of fundamental knowledge and skills (reading, writing, arithmetic, reasoning, respecting the values of the Republic, etc.) that every child must master by the end of each major cycle:

- **End of nursery school**
- **End of primary school**
- **End of lower-secondary school**
- **End of upper-secondary school**

The Federal State would also guarantee the national value of the major diplomas (the Brevet and the Baccalauréat) through standardized assessments, thereby ensuring equality of opportunity and the mobility of students across the whole territory.

Chapter III: Justice — Bringing Closer, Accelerating, Repairing

A. The Diagnosis: A Pillar of the Republic on the Brink of Collapse

An independent, accessible, and effective justice system is the ultimate guarantor of the rule of law. Yet the French judicial institution is going through a deep crisis that feeds mistrust and threatens the social pact. Targeted by populist and conspiracy-driven rhetoric, its glaring lack of resources offers fertile ground for citizens' frustration and the exhaustion of its professionals.

- **An Under-Resourced Justice System:**

Despite a recent increase, the justice budget remains one of the lowest in Europe. With **0.20% of its GDP devoted to the judicial system**[23], France lies well below the European median (0.3%). This chronic under-investment translates into a glaring shortage of staff: France has only **11.2 professional judges per 100,000 inhabitants, compared with 25**

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[23] CEPEJ report (2022 data, cited by Vie-publique.fr).

in Germany[24]. The announced recruitment plans, though necessary, struggle to make up a structural shortfall.

- **Intolerable Delays and Eroded Trust:**

The direct consequence for citizens is a slowness that amounts to a denial of justice. Average times to judgment are counted in years, exceeding, for example, **15 months on average before a court of appeal in civil matters**[25]. This situation, coupled with a perceived complexity, fuels a sense of powerlessness and inequality and wears away the French people's trust in the institution.

- **The Prison System, the Shame of the Republic:**

The state of French prisons is a moral failure and a permanent violation of human rights. The latest Council of Europe report is damning: with an occupancy rate of **124 detainees per 100 places**[26], France has one of the most overcrowded prison systems in Europe. This figure conceals a dramatic reality described each year by the Inspector-General of Places of Deprivation of Liberty: "degrading" conditions of detention, an overcrowding that forbids any prospect of reintegration, and endemic violence. Far from being a tool of social repair, prison has become a "school of crime" that manufactures reoffending.

B. The Federal Solution: A Two-Tier Justice System for Greater Effectiveness

The federal project provides a structural response by distinguishing the norm from its management.

- **Federal Justice, Guardian of Equality:**

The Federal State would remain the only authority competent to write the major codes (Civil, Criminal) and to guarantee the single status and independence of judges. The equality of citizens before the law is thus safeguarded across the whole territory.

- **Regional Management, a Lever of Effectiveness:**

Each Region would be responsible for the administrative and budgetary management of its courts (buildings, registries, digital equipment). This local management would make it possible to match resources to the real needs of each territory.

- **"Community Justice," a Revolution of the Everyday:**

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[24] Fondation IFRAP (citing the Council of Europe).

[25] Ministry of Justice ("Key Figures 2022").

[26] Council of Europe, SPACE I 2023 report (on prison statistics).

To relieve congestion in the courts, a community justice would be created at the municipal level. Composed of **citizen-magistrates** (elected or drawn by lot, trained and sworn in), it would rapidly handle everyday disputes (neighbour conflicts, small claims, incivilities, etc.).

- **The Regionalization of Prisons: The Key to Reintegration**

Entrusting the management of the prison administration to the Regions is the only way out of the current impasse. A "Regional Directorate of Prison Affairs" would have the levers to:

- **Build human-scale prisons:** Put an end to the gigantic "inmate factories" disconnected from everything, in favour of smaller establishments, better distributed across the territory and specialized (remand prisons, semi-custody centres, structures for short sentences, etc.).
- **Connect the prison to local economic and social life:** This is the main asset. Since the Region is also competent for **vocational training** and **business support**, it could create training pathways in prison that lead directly to the jobs available in the local economic area.
- **Ensure continuity of care:** In connection with the "Regional Ministry of Health," the Region could put in place genuine medical and psychological follow-up, particularly for addictions, that would continue without interruption upon release from prison.
- **Actively prepare for release:** By also steering **housing** and **employment** policies, the Region could coordinate all actors so that a genuine reintegration plan (housing, work, social follow-up) is ready on the day of release — an indispensable condition for effectively combating reoffending.

Chapter IV: Health — The Territories at the Controls

A. The Diagnosis: A System of Excellence on the Verge of Asphyxiation

Our health system, long regarded as one of the best in the world, is running out of breath. The exhaustion of staff, the deterioration of access to care, and a structural financial crisis are no longer weak signals, but the symptoms of a hyper-centralized organization that is no longer in step with the country's needs.

A Financial and Human Crisis:

The public hospital is caught in a vice. In 2024, the deficit of public hospitals is expected to reach an unprecedented level of **€2.9 billion**[27], despite a debt that still hovers around **€30 billion**[28]. This financial pressure has direct repercussions on caregivers and patients. "Medical deserts" are spreading: although the total number of doctors is rising slightly, their poor distribution and the retirement of general practitioners leave entire territories

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[27] DREES estimate (published July 2025).

[28] DREES (July 2025).

without any solution for local care. The staff shortage is acute, and projections estimate that there will be a shortfall of **80,000 nurses by 2050**[29] simply to maintain the current level of care in the face of an ageing population.

The Haemorrhage of Talent: The Demoralizing Competition from Neighbours

This internal crisis is massively aggravated by the attractiveness of our neighbours. For border regions, competition from Switzerland, Belgium, and Luxembourg is not a theory; it is a daily haemorrhage. More than **4,500 doctors trained in France already practise abroad**, drawn by objectively better conditions:

- **Incomparable salaries:**

A general practitioner in France earns on average €90,000 per year, compared with **€135,000 to €225,000 in Switzerland**. The gap is even more spectacular for nurses: an average gross annual salary of €32,400 in France against **€62,300 in Belgium**[30].

- **Working conditions that allow caregivers to "care well":**

Beyond salary, it is the quality of work that drives this exodus. A nurse in Switzerland looks after **4 to 6 patients a day, compared with 12 to 15 in France**[31]. It is the difference between humane care and assembly-line work.

- **More agile, decentralized systems:**

These countries have in common largely decentralized health systems. In **Switzerland, the cantons** are responsible for basic care and hospital planning. In **Belgium, it is the Communities** that steer health policy. This local governance gives them an agility and a capacity to adapt that our Jacobin system has lost.

B. The Federal Solution: A Tailor-Made and Competitive Health Policy

In the face of this diagnosis, federalism is not an option; it is a necessity. The aim is to give the territories the levers to care for their inhabitants and to become attractive again.

- **A "Regional Ministry of Health":**

Replacing the Regional Health Agencies (ARS), a genuine elected regional ministry would be created. It would have full responsibility for health policy: the hospital map, community medicine, prevention, the training of paramedical professions, etc.

- **How the Region can become competitive again:**

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[29] DREES projection (December 2024).

[30] OECD comparisons.

[31] ANAP source.

- **Pursue an attractive pay policy:** A Region such as Alsace or the Dauphiné-Lyonnais, directly competing with Switzerland, would have the freedom to vote **pay supplements** for its caregivers in order to align with neighbouring salary levels and stop the haemorrhage.
- **Improve working conditions:** By controlling its budget, the Region could invest massively in recruitment to raise caregiver-to-patient ratios, fund cutting-edge equipment, and modernize hospitals.
- **Combat medical deserts through innovation:** The Region could experiment with agile, tailored solutions: creating regional health centres with salaried doctors, study grants in exchange for a multi-year commitment to practise locally, or developing telemedicine in connection with local "digital buses."
- **Simplify and empower:** The Region, in connection with its "Bercy of the Territories," could lighten the administrative burden on health professionals and give them greater autonomy in organizing care.
- **The Role of the Federal State:**

The Federation would guarantee the **"Republican Foundation of Access to Care"** (the principle of universal health insurance, funded by the national solidarity tax) and would remain the strategic pilot in the face of major health crises (pandemics, management of essential medicines).

By entrusting health to the Regions, we wager on responsibility and on the intelligence of those on the ground to rebuild a care system that is fair, effective, and attractive.

Chapter V: Managing Immigration — A Federalism of Responsibility

The migration question has become the main fuel of populisms in Europe, largely because citizens feel they have been dispossessed of all control, leaving the field open to simplistic rhetoric. A project of republican refoundation cannot evade this subject. On the contrary, it must bring to it a response that is at once democratic, responsible, and effective, by applying the principles of subsidiarity and direct democracy.

Our project proposes to make reception and integration policy a shared competence, in which the Region becomes the central actor, in permanent dialogue with its citizens and its economic actors.

A. Defining Needs: The Regional Referendum on Quotas

The heart of the mechanism is to give decision-making power back to citizens.

- **Principle:** Each year, the Regional Council, after broad consultation with businesses, trade unions, and associations, would propose a draft "framework law on reception and integration." This draft would set **reception quotas for labour immigration** for the coming year, based on the real needs of the regional economy (sectors facing shortages, unfilled occupations).

- **The Citizen Vote:** This bill, with its quotas, would be submitted to an **annual regional referendum**. The Region's citizens would thus directly validate or reject the reception policy of their territory. The purpose of this direct democratic consultation is to legitimize the chosen policy, to cut the ground from under populist rhetoric, and to make citizens co-responsible for the migration policy of their territory.

B. Managing Permits: The Regional Residence Permit

To address the paradox of the absence of internal borders, an innovative mechanism would be created.

- **Principle:** Foreigners admitted under the labour quotas voted by a Region would be issued a **"Regional Residence and Work Permit."**
- **Duration and Conditions:** This permit, valid for **five years**, would authorize its holder to reside and work only within the territory of the Region that received them. Access to social rights (other than medical emergencies) would likewise be conditional on residence in that Region. This mechanism guarantees that the Region that voted for and organized the reception bears its responsibility and reaps its economic benefits.
- **Gateway to Nationality:** After five years of continuous residence and work in the regional territory, and provided the other conditions are met (command of the language, respect for the values of the Republic), the holder of the regional permit could apply for a **national residence permit**, opening the path to French citizenship, which remains an exclusive prerogative of the Federal State.

C. The Role of the Federal State: Guarantor of Borders and the Right of Asylum

The Federal State would retain clear sovereign competences:

- **Control of the external borders** of the Republic and of the Schengen Area.
- **Exclusive management of the right of asylum**, which is an international obligation and not an economic policy.
- **The granting of French nationality**, the ultimate act of sovereignty.

This two-tier system makes it possible to reconcile humanity, economic effectiveness, and democratic sovereignty, turning migration policy from a problem endured into a project chosen and owned by citizens.

Chapter VI: The Path to the Sixth Republic

The transition from one Republic to another cannot be a mere technical reform. It is a major political act that requires absolute democratic legitimacy. The Fifth Republic, designed for a specific historical context, does not contain within itself the tools for its own refoundation. Attempting to transform it from within, through successive constitutional revisions, would only produce a hybrid and unstable system. What is needed, therefore, is a "constituent moment": a time when the nation reclaims the power to define its own rules.

Section 1: Convening a Constituent Assembly

The Constituent Assembly is the only democratically legitimate body to draft a new Constitution. But its convening is the most delicate step, for it marks the break with the old order.

A. The Triggering Context: The Crisis of Legitimacy

Such a break can only occur in the wake of a deep crisis, in which the system in place is no longer perceived as the solution, but as the problem. This context would be the convergence of three crises:

A crisis of state effectiveness: A paralysis of public decision-making, an inability to respond to the great challenges (ecological, social, economic), creating a sense of collective powerlessness.

A crisis of representation: Record abstention rates, generalized mistrust of institutions and traditional political parties, and powerful social movements (of the "Gilets Jaunes" / Yellow Vests type, but on a larger scale) that challenge the very legitimacy of the system.

A territorial crisis: A revolt of local elected officials and citizens of "peripheral" territories against Parisian centralization, perceived as an obstacle to development and democracy.

B. The Initiative: Who Can Press the Button?

The 1958 Constitution does not provide for its own end. The initiative can therefore arise only from a conjunction of legality and legitimacy:

Popular legitimacy: The impetus must come from below. It cannot be a project carried by a single party, which would immediately be accused of seeking to seize power. The impulse must be given by a vast cross-partisan citizens' movement, federating local elected officials of every persuasion, trade unions, associations, intellectuals, and engaged citizens. This movement would have a single rallying cry, simple and unifying: "Let us give the people the floor to write their own rules."

Institutional legality: Faced with massive and organized popular pressure, the President of the Republic would be the only authority able to provide a legal way out of the crisis. By using Article 11[32] of the current Constitution, they would not submit a new constitution to referendum (which would be a denial of democracy), but a single question: "Do you approve the election, by direct universal suffrage, of a Constituent Assembly charged with drafting a new Constitution for the Sixth Republic?" This is the most credible path: a

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[32] Constitution of the Fifth Republic of 4 October 1958. # ANNEXES

"revolution through the ballot box," initiated by the people and validated by the guarantor of the institutions.

C. The Conditions for Success and the Pitfalls to Avoid

Conditions for success:

A clear and exclusive mandate: The Constituent Assembly would have only one power: to draft the Constitution. It would not be a parallel government. During its work, the current institutions (President, Government, Parliament) would continue to handle current affairs to avoid any power vacuum.

Total transparency: All the Assembly's debates would have to be public and broadcast to guarantee citizens' ownership of the process.

An exemplary electoral system: The election of the constituents would have to be by full proportional representation on a regional basis, with strict parity, to ensure that all sensibilities and all territories are represented.

Pitfalls to avoid:

Institutional chaos: The risk of a conflict of legitimacy between the Constituent Assembly and the sitting President. The strict limitation of the Assembly's mandate is the main safeguard.

Capture by partisan interests: The risk that the process is hijacked by organized groups. The best protection is a broad and diverse initial citizens' movement.

Democratic fatigue: The process will be long. It will need to be paced by clear stages and constant communication to maintain citizen mobilization.

Section 2: Negotiating the "Federal Pact" Within the Assembly

Once elected, the Constituent Assembly becomes the crucible of the new Republic. Its work is not only technical; it is eminently political. It is here that the historic compromise between the different visions of France must be forged, through dialogue and at times confrontation. This great negotiation would be structured around three fundamental axes.

A. The Delimitation of Competences: The Inviolable Republican Foundation and Regional Freedom

The success of the federal pact rests on an absolutely clear delimitation of competences. The aim is not to create a mosaic of 25 unmanageable sets of regulations, but to apply the principle of subsidiarity intelligently: what unites us must be managed in common at the Federal level; what benefits from being adapted to local realities must be managed by the Regions.

To guarantee clarity, simplicity, and the protection of fundamental rights, we establish the principle of an **"Inviolable Republican Foundation."** This foundation defines the exclusive perimeter of federal law — a set of rules that apply uniformly across the entire territory and that no Region may alter.

The "Inviolable Republican Foundation": The Exclusive Domain of Federal Law

This foundation is the guarantor of the Nation's unity, of citizens' equality, and of the fluidity of the national market. It comprises:

- **The Foundation of Freedoms and Common Law:**
- The **fundamental freedoms** guaranteed by the Constitution.
- The major **legal codes** that structure society: the Civil Code (contract law, family law, etc.), the Criminal Code, the Commercial Code. A company must be able to sign a contract or defend itself in court in the same way in Lille and in Marseille.
- **The Foundation of Solidarity and Social Rights:**
- **Fundamental labour law:** The following rules fall under exclusive federal competence:
- The **statutory national minimum wage (SMIC)**.
- The **maximum legal duration** of work.
- The rules of the **employment contract** (probationary period, conditions of termination, etc.).
- The **right to strike** and **trade-union representation**.
- **Social security and pensions:** The principles and basic rules of the major national solidarity schemes (health insurance, unemployment insurance) and of the pay-as-you-go pension schemes remain federal. A worker will contribute in the same way and have the same pension rights whether they worked in Bretagne or in Alsace.

The Foundation of the Economy and the Ecological Transition:

- **Corporate income tax**, **VAT**, and the major **environmental standards** (air and water quality, the banning of hazardous substances, etc.).

B. Regional Freedom: The Domain of Intelligent Adaptations

Outside this inviolable foundation, the Regions hold general legislative power. On economic and social questions, "regional adaptations" are therefore not an open door to social dumping, but precisely delimited powers of adjustment.

What the Regions will be able to do:

- **Vocational training:** Define specific qualifying programmes, directly linked to the needs of the industrial sectors of their territory.

- **Apprenticeship:** Create grants and incentives to promote apprenticeship in sectors deemed priorities for the regional economy.
- **Employment support:** Put in place hiring incentives targeted at certain groups (young people, older workers) or certain sectors facing labour shortages.
- **Organization of working time in specific sectors:** While strictly respecting the federal maximum duration, a mountain tourism region could, for example, define specific frameworks for organizing the work of seasonal staff, in agreement with local social partners.

What the Regions will NEVER be able to do:

- Create a regional minimum wage lower than the federal SMIC.
- Modify the conditions for terminating a permanent (open-ended) employment contract.
- Call into question the right to strike.
- Withdraw from the pay-as-you-go pension system.

The "Sinews of War": The Financial and Solidarity Pact

This is the most critical negotiation, the one whose outcome conditions all the rest. It is a matter of answering the question: "Who pays what, and for whom?"

- The stakes:
- To define the rules of the Regions' fiscal autonomy and, above all, the mechanisms of the Federal Solidarity Fund.
- The foreseeable points of friction:
- Tension will be at its highest between the "net contributor" regions (such as Île-de-France or the Dauphiné-Lyonnais), which will argue for a limited contribution, and the "net beneficiary" regions, which will demand strong equalization to guarantee equal public services across the whole territory.
- The method:
- The success of this negotiation would rest on transparency. Public budgetary simulations would show the impact of the various equalization formulas. The aim would be to find a "fair return" that guarantees both the indispensable solidarity and the preservation of the competitiveness of the most dynamic regions.

C. The Institutional Architecture: Organizing the Checks and Balances

This would involve designing the new institutions so that they guarantee the balance of the system.

- The stakes:
- To define the exact powers of the Senate of the Regions. Will it be a mere oversight chamber or a powerful co-legislator?
- The foreseeable points of friction:
- The debate will bear on the extent of its veto power. Should it concern only laws directly affecting the finances of the regions, or extend to other areas?
- The method:
- A comparative study of foreign models (the German Bundesrat, the American and Spanish Senates) would inform the debates in order to find a solution suited to the French political tradition.

To guarantee popular support, this entire negotiation process would be open, drawing on citizens' conventions (with citizens selected by lot) that would issue opinions on the major chapters of the future Constitution, and on a digital platform for permanent consultation.

Section 3: The Timeline of the Constituent Process

Such a process cannot be conducted in haste. It requires time for maturation, debate, and decision.

Phase 1: Build-up and Initial Referendum (6 to 12 months): The time for the citizens' movement to take shape and for political pressure to lead to the convening of the referendum on the principle of the Constituent Assembly.

Phase 2: Election of the Assembly (3 to 6 months): The time to pass the organic law setting the rules of the ballot, to campaign, and to elect the constituents.

Phase 3: Work of the Constituent Assembly and Negotiation of the Federal Pact (12 to 18 months): An irreducible period to debate, consult citizens, and draft a complete and coherent text.

Phase 4: Referendum Campaign and Final Vote (3 to 6 months): The time to present the project to the country and to adopt it through the double-majority referendum we have defined.

Total estimated duration: About two and a half to three and a half years. This is the time needed to carry out a serious and peaceful democratic refoundation.

Chapter VII: A Federal Republic at the Heart of a Sovereign Europe

Our project of republican refoundation is not a project of withdrawal. On the contrary, it aims to give France back the means to fully hold its rank within the European Union. A more agile, stronger, and more democratic France is a France better able to carry the European project.

Section 1: Assured Constitutional and Institutional Compatibility

The move to a federal organization in no way calls into question France's European commitments. The architecture we propose is designed for a smooth and even improved integration within the Union.

The Primacy of European Law: The principle of the primacy of Union law over national law, as interpreted by the Court of Justice of the European Union and recognized by the Constitutional Council, would be explicitly reaffirmed in the new Constitution.

The Federal State, the Union's Interlocutor: The Federal State would remain the sole representative of the French Republic within the European institutions (the European Council, the Council of the EU). The Federal Ministry of Foreign Affairs would retain the conduct of France's European policy.

Improved Transposition of Directives: The Senate of the Regions would play a key role in the transposition of European directives. Like the German Bundesrat, it would be mandatorily consulted on all European texts affecting the competences of the Regions (environment, agriculture, regional development, etc.). This upstream involvement would guarantee a faster, more effective transposition better adapted to realities on the ground, putting an end to the delays and litigation that cost France dearly.

The Presence of the Regions in Brussels: Each Region would have the ability to maintain a representation office in Brussels to defend its specific interests and take part in European programmes, as the German Länder and the Spanish regions already do.

Section 2: A Renewed Partner for a Stronger Europe

More fundamentally, our project is a response to France's relative stagnation, which holds back Europe as a whole. By unleashing territorial energies, we want to make France the second indispensable engine of a sovereign Europe.

The argument to make to our European partners is simple: French centralism, a source of slowness and rigidity, is a European problem. A federal and agile France, with 25 dynamic poles of growth, would be a considerable asset for the continent. By reawakening its economic potential, France would strengthen the single market, contribute more to the Union's economic power, and form with Germany a more balanced — and therefore more stable — driving partnership. It is in this perspective that we propose a major investment plan co-financed by the European Union.

Annex 1: Portraits of the Cultural Regions

The purpose of this annex is to sketch the identity of each Region proposed in this project. Far from a nostalgic return to the past, it aims to show how a strong historical and cultural anchoring constitutes the best soil on which to build an innovative future and an active citizenship.

Île-de-France

Heritage and Identity: The political and intellectual heart of France for more than a thousand years, Île-de-France is the crucible of the Nation. Its identity is not that of a province, but that of a state in permanent construction — a territory whose destiny has always merged with that of the country as a whole. Its pride lies in its **universalism**, its concentration of talent, and its exceptional heritage, witness to all the **great moments of French history**.

- **Examples of universalism:** It was in Paris, at the heart of Île-de-France, that the Enlightenment radiated across the world, and that the **Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen of 1789** was proclaimed, setting a milestone for all of humanity. It remains today one of the world's capitals of culture, fashion, gastronomy, and the exchange of ideas.
- **Examples of heritage:** Its heritage is that of France and of the world: the **Louvre Palace**, from royal fortress to the world's largest museum; **Notre-Dame Cathedral**, the spiritual and historic heart of the nation; the **Palace of Versailles**, symbol of absolutism and masterpiece of classical art; or the **Eiffel Tower**, icon of industrial modernity that became the symbol of France.
- **Examples of great historical moments:** All the great ruptures of French history played out here: the **storming of the Bastille**, founding act of the French Revolution; the **Paris Commune**, the first great modern workers' insurrection; or the **Liberation of Paris in August 1944**, symbol of victory over oppression.

Projection Towards the Future: The future of Île-de-France is that of a World-Region, one of the few global metropolises able to rival London, New York, or Tokyo. Its mission is no longer to command France, but to be its locomotive in global competition, concentrating on its hyper-competences: finance (Euronext), the luxury and creative industries, research and development (the Paris-Saclay cluster), and digital technology.

Dauphiné-Lyonnais

- **Heritage and Identity:** A land of passage and exchange between Northern Europe and the Mediterranean, the Dauphiné-Lyonnais forged for itself the identity of a crossroads. Lyon, capital of the Gauls and later a great merchant and industrial centre, embodies a bourgeois pride, an entrepreneurial spirit, and a culture of innovation (from silk-weaving to biotechnology). The Dauphiné, a former independent principality, brings its mountain character, its spirit of resistance, and its tradition of high technical skill (the "white coal" of hydroelectric power).
- **Projection Towards the Future:** This region has every asset to become Europe's leader in "deep tech": biotechnology (Lyonbiopôle), materials chemistry, artificial intelligence, and digital technology (Minalogic in Grenoble). Its future rests on its capacity to connect the power of its metropolis to the excellence of its Alpine valleys, creating a unique ecosystem where fundamental research meets industrial application.

Pays de Savoie

- **Heritage and Identity:** A former sovereign state, Savoie retains the pride of its Alpine history and its distinct culture. Its identity is that of a land of mountain people — pragmatic, attached to its traditions yet always open to its Swiss and Italian neighbours. Savoyard pride is that of a territory that has managed to turn its natural constraints (the mountains) into a major economic asset.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** The Savoie of the 21st century will be Europe's laboratory for the "new mountain economy." Its future no longer rests on mass tourism alone, but on inventing a sustainable model combining four-season tourism, renewable energy (hydroelectricity, high-altitude solar), and cutting-edge industry (mechatronics and precision machining in the Arve valley, with the Mont-Blanc Industries cluster).

Bretagne (Historic)

- **Heritage and Identity:** With its language, its culture, and its history as a near-independent duchy, Bretagne possesses one of the strongest identities in France. Marked by its dual nature, inland (*Argoat*) and maritime (*Armor*), its identity is one of resilience, strong social cohesion, and a community spirit that has allowed it to overcome crises. Breton pride is that of having achieved, after the war, a spectacular economic modernization while preserving a living culture.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Bretagne is ideally positioned to become a leader in the "blue economy" and in digital sovereignty. Its future is taking shape around the excellence of its naval industry (Naval Group), the development of marine renewable energy, its agri-food power in full ecological transition, and its world-class cyber-defence cluster, which makes it the guardian of our digital security.

Alsace

- **Heritage and Identity:** A pivotal land between the Latin and Germanic worlds, Alsace has a bicultural identity unique in France. Its history, marked by changes of sovereignty, bequeathed it a specific local law, a deep attachment to its freedoms, and a culture of consensus. Alsatian pride is that of a territory at once fiercely French and profoundly European, which has turned its geographic position into an exceptional asset.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Alsace is by nature the "Capital-Region" of Europe. Beyond its political role with the Strasbourg Parliament, its future is to become the European hub of health and life sciences. Building on its "BioValley," one of the densest in Europe, it has the potential to connect research, the pharmaceutical industry, and medtech to meet the continent's great health challenges.

Normandie

- **Heritage and Identity:** From the Viking duchy to the conquest of England, from the D-Day beaches to Impressionism, the history of Normandie is universal. Its identity is that of a land of builders, farmers, and sailors, marked by a legal spirit and a thoughtful moderation. Norman pride is that of a quiet power that has always played a leading role in the political, economic, and artistic history of France.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Normandie is destined to become the heart of France's energy transition. Its future rests on the combination of its historic nuclear cluster, the massive development of offshore wind along its coastline (the largest in France), and its role as the "grand port" of the Seine axis, making it the natural gateway to Greater Paris.

Flandre-Artois (Hauts-de-France)

- **Heritage and Identity:** A former land of the great Counts of Flanders, at the heart of merchant Europe, this region has an identity marked by work, solidarity, and conviviality. Its history is that of coal and textiles, of the "*gueules noires*" (coal miners) and the belfries, which forged a culture of resilience and a working-class pride. The pride of the people of the North is that of having always faced crises and reconversions with an uncommon energy and sense of the collective.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Flandre-Artois is in the midst of succeeding in its third industrial revolution. Its future no longer lies in coal, but in logistics (the e-commerce "hub" for Northern Europe), the new automotive industry (the "electric-battery valley"), and the creative industries (video games, design). Its crossroads position, once a source of misfortune, has become its main asset.

Aquitaine (Guyenne-Gascogne)

- **Heritage and Identity:** A vast territory stretching from the foothills of the Massif Central to the Atlantic, historic Aquitaine is a land of opulence and the art of living. Its identity was built around Bordeaux, a port open to the world that made the region's fortune through its prestigious vineyards. Aquitanian pride is that of a "civilization of wine," an unabashed hedonism, but also a spirit of independence inherited from its past as a duchy with close ties to England.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Aquitaine is destined to be the European leader in civil and military aeronautics and space. Building on the unique ecosystem of Aerospace Valley, which links Bordeaux and Toulouse, its future is to design the decarbonized aircraft, the new generations of space launchers, and the drones of tomorrow. It also has a major role to play in the "bio-economy" by developing a sustainable industry from the largest cultivated forest in Europe, the Landes massif.

Provence

- **Heritage and Identity:** The most anciently Romanized land of France, Provence has a deep Mediterranean identity, marked by the light, the landscapes, and an art of living that has charmed artists from around the world. From the city of the Popes at Avignon to the great port of Marseille, its history is that of a brilliant urban civilization and a constant openness to the sea. Provençal pride is that of a universal culture, of a singing accent, and of a resilience in the face of a sometimes harsh nature.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Provence is called to become the Euro-Mediterranean "hub" of the new routes of globalization. Its future rests on the power of its Marseille-Fos port complex, the southern gateway to Europe, which must become the first "green" port of the Mediterranean. It is also a key player in the energy transition, combining a petrochemical industry in reconversion, the development of hydrogen, and the power of its aeronautics industry (Airbus Helicopters).

Toulousain-Pyrénées

- **Heritage and Identity:** Former capital of the Visigothic kingdom and later the heart of the County of Toulouse, one of the most powerful in medieval France, this region has a strong identity, marked by Occitan culture and a tradition of independent-mindedness. The "Pink City" embodies an intellectual and festive pride, while the Pyrenean massif brings its rugged character and pastoral culture. The pride of this territory is that of having always been a pole of innovation, from the troubadours to the Aéropostale.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Like its Aquitanian neighbour, the region is a world leader in aeronautics and space. Its specific future is to become the European capital of "embedded systems" and applied artificial intelligence. Building on its world-class competitiveness cluster (Aerospace Valley), its universities, and its research centres (CNES, Thales), its mission is to design the digital brains of the aircraft, satellites, and autonomous vehicles of tomorrow.

Bourgogne

- **Heritage and Identity:** The memory of the Grand Duchy of the West, rival of the kingdom of France, left Bourgogne a prestigious identity and an exceptional heritage (Cluny, Cîteaux, the Hospices de Beaune). Its identity is that of a land of balance, of viticultural "*climats*" listed as World Heritage, and of a gastronomy that radiates across the world. Burgundian pride is that of patient work, of a quest for excellence, and of a refined art of living.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Bourgogne is ideally placed to become the European leader in "precision agro-ecology" and sustainable gastronomy. Its future rests on its capacity to combine its ancestral winegrowing know-how with new technologies (drones, sensors) for a more environmentally respectful agriculture. Building on the Vitagora competitiveness cluster, it can invent the foods and beverages of tomorrow, healthier and more sustainable.

Franche-Comté

- **Heritage and Identity:** Long an imperial land — "*franche*" because exempt from taxes — the Comté forged an independent and industrious character. Its identity is that of a land of forests and mountains (the Jura), marked by a culture of precision born of watchmaking. Comtois pride is that of work well done, of cooperation (the cheese-making "*fruitières*"), and of a discretion that does not exclude very high technical skill.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Franche-Comté is destined to become the European pole of microtechnology and cutting-edge medical devices. Capitalizing on its historic know-how in the infinitely small, and building on its Microtechnology Cluster, its future is to design and produce the smart components, connected implants, and next-generation prosthetics that will revolutionize the health of tomorrow.

Languedoc

- **Heritage and Identity:** Heart of Occitan civilization and of Catharism, Languedoc has a rebellious identity and a history marked by resistance to central power. A land of vineyards and dynamic cities such as Montpellier, its identity is that of great intellectual creativity and a strong openness to the Mediterranean. Languedocian pride is that of a culture and a language that radiated across all of Europe, and of a capacity to always reinvent itself.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Languedoc is becoming a leader in water and health technologies. Building on its Aqua-Valley cluster, it is at the forefront of the smart management of water resources, a crucial challenge for the 21st century. Its medical ecosystem around Montpellier, combining university research and innovative companies, also makes it a major player in diagnostics and new therapies.

Anjou-Maine

- **Heritage and Identity:** A former county at the heart of the Plantagenet empire, this gentle, temperate region is the "Garden of France." Its identity is one of balance between the power of its châteaux (Angers), its horticultural tradition, and a discretion that conceals a strong capacity for innovation. The pride of this territory is that of an art of living, a remarkable architectural heritage, and a fabric of dynamic SMEs.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Anjou-Maine has every asset to become the European leader in "specialized plant science" and connected objects. Its future rests on its Végépolys Valley competitiveness cluster, which invents the plants of tomorrow (more resistant, less water-hungry), and on its ecosystem of electronics companies that design and manufacture the sensors and smart objects for agriculture, industry, and the home.

Centre-Val de Loire

- **Heritage and Identity:** Land of the kings of France during the Renaissance, the Val de Loire is marked by an architectural heritage unique in the world, that of the Châteaux of the Loire. Its identity is that of an exceptional cultural landscape, a "*douceur de vivre*," and a crossroads position at the heart of the country. The pride of this region is to be the face of a certain French genius, combining the beauty of nature with the refinement of culture.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Centre-Val de Loire is destined to strengthen its position as world leader of the "Cosmetic Valley." Building on the presence of the greatest names in luxury and pharmaceuticals, its future is to become the research and production pole of the "green" cosmetics and pharmaceuticals of tomorrow, using its territory's plant resources to create more natural and sustainable products. Its role as a logistics hub is also set to grow.

Lorraine

- **Heritage and Identity:** A former independent duchy with a strong identity, Lorraine is a borderland, marked by the industrial history of iron and steel. Its identity is that of toil, of working-class pride, and of a tradition of a "genius for materials," from Baccarat crystalware to the steel industry. Lorraine's pride is that of a land that was one of the engines of French industrial power and that has always known how to face change.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Lorraine is in the midst of succeeding in its transition towards the industry of the future. Its future is no longer limited to steelmaking, but extends to materials science and health. Building on its Materalia cluster and on the excellence of its Cancer Institute, its mission is to design the smart materials and biotechnologies that will be at the heart of tomorrow's innovations.

Auvergne

- **Heritage and Identity:** A land of volcanoes and high plateaus at the heart of the Massif Central, the Auvergne has a rugged and authentic identity. It is a land of farmers, cutlers, and discreet innovators, in the image of Michelin. Its isolation forged a tenacious character and a strong sense of belonging. Auvergnat pride is that of a powerful nature and of a capacity to create wealth and world-class innovation from a landlocked territory.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** The Auvergne is the natural leader of "sustainable mobility." Capitalizing on the unique ecosystem created by Michelin, its future is to become the world centre of research on innovative materials for transport, on non-polluting tyres, and on new mobility solutions (hydrogen, connected services). Its quality-focused agricultural model is also a major asset for the future.

Poitou-Charentes-Vendée

- **Heritage and Identity:** An Atlantic seaboard open to the wide ocean, this region is a land of sailors, traders, and entrepreneurs. Its identity is marked by the dynamism of its ports (La Rochelle), the power of its vineyard (Cognac), and a particularly strong spirit of initiative, especially in the Vendée. The pride of this territory is that of a spirit of adventure, a capacity to conquer global markets, and a powerful mutualist model (the insurers of Niort).

- **Projection Towards the Future:** This region's vocation is to become the European pole of boating and composite materials. Building on world leaders such as the Bénéteau group, its future is to design the boats of tomorrow, greener and smarter. Its agri-food model and its mutualist financial cluster are also solid pillars for its development.

Champagne

- **Heritage and Identity:** Land of the medieval fairs and of the coronation of the kings of France at Reims, Champagne has a rich and prestigious history. Its identity is inseparable from the wine that bears its name and that has become a universal symbol of celebration and luxury. Champenois pride is that of a unique savoir-faire, of an exceptional product that conquered the world, and of a capacity to rise again from the destruction of wars.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Champagne's mission is to become the world model of "sustainable luxury viticulture." Faced with climate change, its future rests on its capacity to innovate in order to preserve the excellence of its terroir while reducing its ecological footprint. It is also a major player in the bio-economy, transforming its agricultural resources into materials and green chemistry.

Pays Catalan

- **Heritage and Identity:** Gateway to the Iberian Peninsula, the French Pays Catalan shares a language and a culture with its neighbours to the south. Its identity is that of a Mediterranean and mountainous land, proud of its traditions and its assertive character. Perpignan, former capital of the Kingdom of Majorca, bears witness to this rich and open history.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** The Pays Catalan is the natural logistics "hub" between Northern Europe and Spain. Its future rests on the development of its Saint-Charles International multimodal platform, Europe's leading centre for the marketing of fruit and vegetables. It also has a major card to play in sustainable tourism and renewable energy, particularly solar.

Picardie

- **Heritage and Identity:** Land of the great Gothic cathedrals (Amiens, Beauvais) and battlefield of the Great War, Picardie has an identity marked by the land and by memory. It is a powerful agricultural region and a land of strong popular traditions. Picard pride is that of resilience, of a capacity to rebuild, and of a deep attachment to its heritage.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Picardie is becoming a key player in plant chemistry and logistics. Its future rests on its capacity to transform its immense agricultural resources (sugar beet, wheat, potatoes) into bioplastics, biofuels, and molecules for pharmaceuticals. Its geographic position also makes it an essential link in the logistics of Northern Europe.

Alpes du Sud

- **Heritage and Identity:** A high-mountain space at the crossroads of Alpine and Provençal influences, the Southern Alps have an identity forged by isolation and the harshness of the climate. It is a land of perched villages, pastoral traditions, and spectacular nature. The pride of its inhabitants is that of having preserved an exceptional living environment and a strong social bond.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** The Southern Alps are the laboratory of "sustainable mountain tourism." Their future is not to copy the great resorts, but to invent a four-season model based on the valorization of their natural parks, the development of gentle outdoor activities, and the promotion of their high-quality mountain agricultural products. The development of renewable energy (hydroelectricity, solar) is also a major axis.

Corse

- **Heritage and Identity:** The "Isle of Beauty," Corsica has an insular and Mediterranean identity of exceptional strength, with its own language, its culture, and a history marked by the quest for independence (Pascal Paoli). It is a "mountain in the sea," with traditions and a code of honour that still strongly structure society. Corsican pride is that of a preserved culture and a visceral attachment to its land.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** Corsica's vocation is to become a model of sustainable island development in the Mediterranean. Its future rests on mastering its tourism development, favouring quality over quantity. It must also bank on very high-quality agriculture and craftsmanship (PDO/PGI labels) and on its renewable-energy potential to achieve energy autonomy.

Limousin

- **Heritage and Identity:** A land of forests, springs, and livestock, the Limousin is the country's green heart. Its identity is that of a land of discreet, excellent craftsmanship, from the fire arts (Limoges porcelain, enamels) to luxury tanning. It is also a land of resistance and a strong left-wing tradition. Limousin pride is that of a preserved authenticity and a capacity to produce luxury and high quality far from the major urban centres.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** The Limousin's mission is to become a pole of excellence of the "economy of the living." Its future rests on a sustainable agricultural model, centred on quality livestock farming and the preservation of its water resources. It must also capitalize on its know-how in the luxury trades and develop new sectors around wood-based eco-materials.

Pays Niçois-Côte d'Azur

- **Heritage and Identity:** A former county attached to France late in its history, the Pays Niçois has an identity strongly influenced by its proximity to Italy. The Côte d'Azur, invented by the European aristocracy in the 19th century, gave it a universal image of luxury and leisure. The identity of this territory is therefore twofold: that, popular and mercantile, of the old town of Nice, and that, cosmopolitan and glamorous, of its coastline.

- **Projection Towards the Future:** The Côte d'Azur is destined to become the European leader in "smart mobility technologies and tourism." Building on the Sophia Antipolis technology park, its future is to design the software and embedded systems for the vehicles of the future and to become the laboratory of new forms of tourism (personalized experiences, AI-driven flow management). Its excellence in perfumery and aromas remains an asset unique in the world.

Annex 2: Explanatory Note on the Role of the Department and the Prefect

To ignore the department and the Prefect in a redesign of the State would be like redesigning a car while forgetting the chassis and the steering. This dual institution has been the keystone of French territorial administration for more than two centuries. To understand their role today, one must go back to their creation.

1. Historical Perspective: The Creation of a Centralized Tool of Control

A. 1790: The Department, the Revolution's Anti-Provinces Weapon

On the eve of the Revolution, France is a tangle of provinces of disparate sizes, laws, and traditions (Normandie, Bretagne, Provence, etc.). For the Jacobin revolutionaries, these local identities are a threat to the unity of the "one and indivisible" Nation.

The creation of the departments in 1790[33] is a radical political act:

- **Objective:** To break the old provincial allegiances.
- **Method:** The territory is redrawn into 83 entities of roughly equal size (so that one could reach the administrative seat within a day on horseback), bearing "neutral" names of rivers or mountains.
- **Purpose:** To create a uniform grid of the territory so that the law, voted in Paris, could be applied everywhere in the same way. The department was born as a tool of rationalization and centralization.

B. 1800: The Prefect, the Eye and the Arm of Napoleon

The Revolution created the framework; Napoleon Bonaparte would place power within it. With the law of 28 Pluviôse, Year VIII (17 February 1800)[34], he creates the prefectoral corps. The phrase is famous: the Prefect is "the Emperor in miniature."

- **Role:** He is the sole representative of central power in the department. Appointed and dismissed by the head of state, he is not a local elected official but an agent of Paris.
- **Powers:** His powers are immense. He is responsible for everything: maintaining order, applying the laws, levying conscripts for the army, collecting taxes, supervising major public works, transmitting information to Paris, etc. He is also the **head of the departmental executive**: it is he who prepares and executes the

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[33] Decree of 26 February 1790.

[34] Law of 28 Pluviôse, Year VIII (17 February 1800).

budget of the General Council (the elected assembly of the department), which he chairs.

For nearly 180 years, this system would not change fundamentally. The Prefect remained the “boss” of the department, embodying the power of the State in the face of local elected officials.

2. Current Operation: Post-Decentralization Coexistence

The great shift takes place in **1982 with the Defferre Laws**[35]. This is Act I of decentralization, which would redistribute the cards.

A. What is the Department for Today?

Since 1982, the department is no longer merely a State district; it is also a **local authority** in its own right, with its assembly elected by universal suffrage (the **Departmental Council**) and its own executive.

- **The transfer of the executive:** The 1982 law transfers executive power from the Prefect to the **President of the Departmental Council**. It is now this elected official who prepares and executes the budget and directs the departmental administration.
- **The key competence: solidarity.** Successive laws made the Department the lead body for **social action**. This is its main mission today. It manages:
- Social benefits: the RSA (the active solidarity income, a guaranteed minimum income), the APA (the personalized autonomy allowance for the elderly), and the PCH (the disability compensation benefit).
- Child protection (the *Aide Sociale à l’Enfance* — Child Welfare Service, ASE).
- The management of lower-secondary schools (construction, maintenance, non-teaching staff).
- The management of departmental roads.

B. What is the Role of the Prefect Today?

The Prefect has lost their local executive power, but remains a central and powerful figure. They embody the permanence and legitimacy of the State across the territory.

- **Representative of the State:** They are the direct representative of the Prime Minister and of each minister. They direct all of the State’s services in the department (the departmental directorates of infrastructure, agriculture, etc.).

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[35] The Defferre Laws of 1982 (Act I of decentralization).

- **Guarantor of public order:** They are the foremost police authority. They have authority over the police and gendarmerie forces to maintain security. It is they who manage crisis situations (natural disasters, demonstrations, etc.).
- **Guardian of the law (the "review of legality"):** This is an essential power. The Prefect no longer gives their approval *before* a decision by local elected officials, but reviews it *afterwards*. If they consider that a decision by a mayor or by the president of the department is unlawful, they refer it to the administrative court to have it annulled.
- **Implementer of public policy:** They are responsible for applying national policies at the local level (employment, housing, environment, etc.). It is they who distribute State subsidies to municipalities for their projects.

In short, the current situation is a **duo**: the **President of the Departmental Council**, an elected official, manages solidarity and local policies, while the **Prefect**, a senior civil servant, guarantees the State's presence, respect for the law, and security across the whole territory. It is the face of a "one and indivisible" France within a Republic that has chosen decentralization.

Annex 3: The Global Income and Wealth Tax (IGRP) — Detailed Analysis

1. Benefits / Risks Analysis of the Fiscal Reform

Any reform of this scale carries risks, but in our project they are controlled and far outweighed by the expected benefits.

Expected Benefits	Potential Risks
Massive simplicity for citizens: the end of the income-tax return for 95% of households.	Complexity of the transition: moving from one system to the other is a major legal and technical operation.
Efficiency and yield: generalized withholding at source on a broad base is the most efficient way to collect tax and combat fraud.	Political and corporatist resistance: any change of this magnitude will provoke strong opposition from those who benefit from the current system.
Greater fiscal justice: combining progressivity on income with a targeted contribution on very large fortunes is fairer than the current system.	Risk of a "flight of the wealthy": a tax on wealth, even modernized, may encourage the wealthiest to seek tax exile.
Transparency and accountability: collection by the Region makes the tax more concrete and the local political power directly accountable for its use.	Financing of municipalities: the abolition of direct local taxes requires reinventing the financial link between the Region and its municipalities.

2. How to Overcome the Implementation Pitfalls

- **The pitfall of technical complexity:** A planned, technology-assisted transition. The IT switchover will be prepared by a dedicated transition authority, building on the existing expertise within the DGFiP (the public finances directorate). The transition will not be a "big bang," but a controlled process over 2 to 3 years.

- **The pitfall of political resistance:** A discourse of truth and the mobilization of the silent majority. By demonstrating, through clear simulations, that the great majority of households will see their administrative burden disappear and their overall tax not increase, a very broad political coalition can be built.

- **The pitfall of wealth flight:** An intelligent and moderate tax. The "wealth component" of the IGRP is not a return to the old ISF (wealth tax). By being assessed on *net* worth (after deduction of debts), with a high allowance and *low* rates, it is far more legitimate.

- **The pitfall of municipal financing:** Enshrining the principle of municipalities' financial autonomy in the Constitution. The regional finance law will define, after consultation, a transparent allocation formula based on objective criteria, thereby giving local elected officials the visibility needed to build their budgets.

Annex 4: Simulation and Analysis of the Dual-Flow Architecture

The table below simulates the financial flows between the Regions and the Federal State, based on the following assumptions: a national IGRP of €300bn, a federal contribution of 20% of the regional IGRP, and a Solidarity Fund of €50bn.

Simulation Table of the Dual-Flow Architecture (in € billions per year)

Region	Upward Flow — Contribution (€bn)	Downward Flow — Solidarity (€bn)	Net Flow for Region (€bn)
Île-de-France	19.22	0	−19.22
Dauphiné-Lyonnais	4.50	0	−4.50
Pays de Savoie	1.20	0	−1.20
Pays Niçois-Côte d'Azur	1.00	0.12	−0.88
Alsace	1.59	1.05	−0.55
Bretagne (Historic)	3.77	4.01	0.24
Aquitaine (Guyenne-Gascogne)	2.93	1.95	−0.98
Provence	3.39	4.42	1.04
Toulousain-Pyrénées	2.53	1.50	−1.03
Flandre-Artois	2.87	5.36	2.49
Normandie	2.43	3.77	1.35
Bourgogne	1.15	1.99	0.84
Franche-Comté	0.81	1.67	0.86

Region	Upward Flow — Contribution (€bn)	Downward Flow — Solidarity (€bn)	Net Flow for Region (€bn)
Languedoc	1.75	4.06	2.32
Anjou-Maine	1.14	1.83	0.68
Centre-Val de Loire	1.82	3.27	1.45
Lorraine	1.60	3.15	1.55
Auvergne	0.99	1.49	0.50
Poitou-Charentes-Vendée	1.77	3.40	1.63
Champagne	1.04	1.01	−0.03
Pays Catalan	0.30	0.88	0.58
Picardie	1.31	2.93	1.62
Alpes du Sud	0.19	0.57	0.38
Corse	0.23	0.51	0.28
Limousin	0.49	1.05	0.56

Analysis of the Simulation: This table makes the principle of federal solidarity concrete. One clearly observes the **net-contributor regions** (Île-de-France, Dauphiné-Lyonnais), whose economic dynamism largely finances federal spending and solidarity, and the **net-beneficiary regions** (Flandre-Artois, Languedoc), which receive the funds needed to make up their wealth deficit and guarantee an equivalent level of public services. It demonstrates how the proposed architecture combines local responsibility with powerful national solidarity.

Annex 5: Mapping of the Regional Strategic Sectors

Mapping of the Strategic Sectors

Cultural Region	Strategic Sectors and Centres of Excellence	Examples of Players and Competitiveness Clusters
Alsace	**Health & Pharma**, **Automotive & Mobility**, **Mechanics & Materials**	BioValley France cluster, Sanofi, Lilly, Stellantis plant (Mulhouse), Hager
Lorraine	**Materials & Industrial Processes**, **Health & Biotechnology**, **Wood & Bio-economy**	Materalia cluster, ArcelorMittal, Saint-Gobain, Lorraine Cancer Institute
Champagne	**Wines & Spirits**, **Agro-industry & Bio-economy**, **Logistics**	Comité Champagne, Vivescia, Industries & Agro-Resources (IAR) cluster

Cultural Region	Strategic Sectors and Centres of Excellence	Examples of Players and Competitiveness Clusters
Flandre-Artois	**Logistics & E-commerce**, **Automotive**, **Health & Nutrition**, **Creative Industries**	Toyota (Onnaing), Alstom (Petite-Forêt), Euralogistic cluster, Eurasanté cluster, Ankama
Picardie	**Agro-industry & Plant Chemistry**, **Logistics**, **Industrial Equipment**	IAR cluster, Bonduelle, Saint-Louis Sucre, aeronautics hub (Méaulte)
Normandie	**Energy** (nuclear, wind), **Aeronautics & Automotive**, **Pharma & Cosmetics**	Orano, EDF, Siemens Gamesa, ArianeGroup, Renault (Cléon), Cosmetic Valley cluster
Bretagne (Hist.)	**Blue Economy** (naval, marine renewables), **Agri-food**, **Cyber-defence & Digital**	Naval Group, Pôle Mer Bretagne Atlantique, Cyber Excellence Cluster, Ubisoft
Anjou-Maine	**Specialized Plant Science**, **Electronics & Connected Objects**, **Fashion & Soft Materials**	Végépolys Valley cluster, Eolane, luxury groups (LVMH, Hermès workshops)
Poitou-Charentes-Vendée	**Boating & Composite Materials**, **Agri-food**, **Insurance & Services**	Bénéteau Group, S2E2 cluster (Smart Electricity), MAIF, MACIF (Niort)
Limousin	**Luxury & Tableware Arts**, **Livestock & Agri-food**, **Electrical Equipment**	Bernardaud, Weston, Legrand, Inno'vin cluster (beef)
Île-de-France	**Financial Services**, **Luxury & Creation**, **Aeronautics & Defence**, **R&D & Digital**	Euronext, LVMH, Kering, Dassault Aviation, Safran, Systematic Paris-Region cluster
Centre-Val de Loire	**"Cosmetic Valley"**, **Pharma**, **Logistics**, **Agri-food**	Cosmetic Valley cluster (LVMH, Shiseido), Sanofi, Amazon, Axereal
Bourgogne	**Wines & Gastronomy**, **Energy** (nuclear), **Automotive**, **Agro-equipment**	BIVB, Framatome, Nuclear Valley cluster, Vitagora cluster
Franche-Comté	**Microtechnology & Luxury Watchmaking**, **Automotive**, **Health & Medical Devices**	Microtechnology Cluster, Stellantis (Sochaux), Swatch Group, LVMH (watchmaking)
Pays de Savoie	**Tourism & Mountain**, **Mechatronics & Precision Machining**, **Renewable Energy**	Compagnie des Alpes, Mont-Blanc Industries cluster, Somfy, CEA-Liten (INES)
Dauphiné-Lyonnais	**Life Sciences & Biotechnology**, **Chemistry & Materials**, **Digital**	Lyonbiopôle cluster, Sanofi Pasteur, Solvay, Minalogic cluster, Ubisoft
Auvergne	**Sustainable Mobility**, **Agri-food**, **Pharma**, **Metallurgy**	Michelin, Limagrain, CARA cluster, MSD, Constellium

Cultural Region	Strategic Sectors and Centres of Excellence	Examples of Players and Competitiveness Clusters
Aquitaine (G-G)	**Aeronautics, Space & Defence**, **Wines & Spirits**, **Wood & Forest**, **Tourism**	Dassault Aviation, Airbus, Thales, CIVB (Bordeaux Wines), Aerospace Valley cluster
Toulousain-Pyrénées	**Aeronautics & Space**, **Agri-food**, **Digital & Embedded Systems**	Airbus (headquarters), CNES, Thales Alenia Space, Aerospace Valley cluster, Agri Sud-Ouest cluster
Languedoc	**Tourism**, **Water & Environment**, **Health**, **Agri-food** (viticulture)	Aqua-Valley cluster, Horiba, BRL, CIVL (Languedoc Wines)
Pays Catalan	**Tourism**, **Agri-food** (fruit & vegetables), **Logistics & Transport**	Saint-Charles International (Europe's leading fruit-and-vegetable hub), Port-Vendres
Provence	**Energy & Petrochemicals**, **Blue Economy**, **Aeronautics**, **Tourism**	TotalEnergies (Fos), CMA CGM, Airbus Helicopters, Pôle Mer Méditerranée
Pays Niçois-Côte d'Azur	**Digital & IT**, **Luxury Tourism**, **Perfumery & Aromas**, **Health**	Sophia Antipolis technology park, Amadeus, Thales, PASS cluster (Perfumes, Aromas, Scents, Flavours)
Alpes du Sud	**Sustainable Tourism**, **Mountain Agri-food**, **Renewable Energy**	Ski resorts, natural parks, certified livestock sectors, EDF dams
Corse	**Sustainable Tourism**, **Quality Agri-food**, **Renewable Energy**	PDO/PGI labels (wines, charcuterie, cheese), Gloria Maris, solar power plants

Annex 6: Budget Estimate of the Plan to End Territorial Isolation

This annex details the estimated budgetary effort required to carry out the "National Plan to End Territorial Isolation and Ensure Territorial Cohesion," as mentioned in Chapter V, Section 3. This is a strategic investment to be planned over a period of 15 to 20 years.

Estimated overall budget envelope: €44 to €52 billion.

Rail Component (High-Speed Lines)

- **Total estimate: €42 to €49 billion**
- **Paris–Orléans–Clermont-Ferrand–Lyon (POCL) project — Clermont section:** €12–14bn
- **Greater South-West Rail Project (GPSO) — Bordeaux–Toulouse & Bordeaux–Dax lines:** €14bn

- **New Paris–Normandy Line (LNPN) — Paris–Rouen section:** €10–15bn
- **New Provence–Côte d'Azur Line (LNPCA) — Phases 1 & 2:** ~€3.5bn
- **Poitiers–Limoges high-speed line project:** ~€2bn (present value)
- **Roissy–Picardie link (for Amiens):** ~€0.4bn

Motorway Component

- **Total estimate: €2 to €3 billion**
- **Completion of the A51 motorway between Grenoble and Gap:** €2–3bn

Financing Perspective

This effort, though massive, represents an annual investment of **€2.2 to €2.6 billion** over 20 years. It would be financed by the Federal State's budget, its borrowing capacity, and the pursuit of co-financing from the European Union. It must be regarded not as an expense, but as an investment in the cohesion and future competitiveness of the entire Nation.

Annex 7: Estimate of the Investment in the Digital Transformation

This annex details the estimated budgetary effort required to carry out the "National Plan for the Digital Transformation of the Territories," as mentioned in Chapter VII. This is a strategic investment essential to the modernization of the State and to the long-term control of public spending.

- **Estimated overall budget envelope: €5 to €10 billion.**
- **Planning:** This investment would be planned over the first 5 years of the new Republic.
- **Financing perspective:** This plan would be financed by the Federal State's budget. It must be regarded as a priority investment, whose return (operating savings, increased efficiency of public services) will far exceed the initial cost.

Annex 8: Outline of a European Investment Plan for the Transformation of France

Plan Title: "France 2040: A Plan for Shared Economic Sovereignty and Territorial Competitiveness"

Framework: A "Next Generation EU"-type programme, adapted to a project of structural transformation of a major member state.

Amount requested: €200 billion over 10 years, in the form of a mix of grants and preferential-rate loans.

Strategic Justification for Europe: Investing in the transformation of France is not aid, but an investment in the competitiveness, resilience, and sovereignty of the European Union as a whole. This plan aims to create a powerful, decentralized second engine of economic growth at the heart of Europe, in perfect alignment with the Union's major objectives (the Green Deal, Digital and Industrial Sovereignty).

Priority Investment Axes:

Axis 1: Ending Isolation and European Connectivity (Budget: €50bn)

Objective: To co-finance the missing links of the trans-European transport network (TEN-T) on French territory.

Projects: The Bordeaux–Toulouse, Paris–Normandy, Marseille–Nice, and Paris–Clermont high-speed lines; completion of the A51 motorway.

European Benefit: Improved fluidity of the single market, strengthened links towards the Iberian Peninsula and Italy.

Axis 2: Digital Transformation and Local Democracy (Budget: €10bn)

Objective: To finance the "Republican Digital Foundation" and the deployment of a 100%-digital regional administration.

European Benefit: The creation of an efficient and resilient e-government model, in line with the EU's "Digital Decade," and the strengthening of active citizenship.

Axis 3: Industrial Specialization and Economic Sovereignty (Budget: €100bn)

Objective: To create a strategic investment fund to co-finance the development plans of each Region's centres of excellence.

Mechanism: The Union would invest in a portfolio of 25 agile regional strategies, targeting the key sectors for European sovereignty (semiconductors, batteries, biotechnology, hydrogen, etc.).

European Benefit: Diversification and strengthening of the EU's industrial base, reduction of strategic dependencies, creation of 100%-European value chains.

Axis 4: Ecological and Energy Transition of the Territories (Budget: €40bn)

Objective: To accelerate the implementation of the European Green Deal at the most relevant level, the Region.

Projects: Regional plans for the thermal renovation of buildings, development of renewable energy (offshore wind in Normandie, solar in Provence, etc.), support for sustainable agriculture.

European Benefit: Accelerated achievement of the Union's climate objectives through the mobilization of local actors.